

MonerOS

User Manual

The open-source, dual-OS ecosystem for sovereign asset management

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Overview

MonerOS is a free, open-source suite of operating systems that helps you manage digital assets securely. It separates transaction preparation from private key signing, which removes the risks that come with keeping your keys on an always-online device.

The ecosystem includes two specialized components: HotWalletOS and ColdWalletOS.

How MonerOS works

MonerOS relies on physical isolation to protect your funds. Instead of trusting a single device, you use two independent environments:

- HotWalletOS (the gateway): A hardened, internet-connected environment that watches the blockchain, prepares transactions, and broadcasts signed data.
- ColdWalletOS (the vault): A strictly offline, air-gapped environment where your private keys live. Use it only to sign transactions that HotWalletOS prepares.

Tip: True security comes from physical isolation. Because your private keys never touch a network, even sophisticated malware can't reach your assets.

Key features

- Hardware independence: Run MonerOS on any standard amd64 PC instead of relying on expensive, closed-source hardware.
- True air-gapped security: ColdWalletOS disables all networking and software installation, which virtually eliminates digital attack vectors.
- Hardened attack surface: Both operating systems are locked down by default, so you get a clean environment dedicated to transaction management.
- Transparent and auditable: Because MonerOS is 100% open-source, the community can review every line of code to confirm there are no backdoors.

Security comparison

Feature	ColdWalletOS	HotWalletOS
Connectivity	Disabled (air-gapped)	Restricted / secure
Software installation	Disabled	Disabled

Feature	ColdWalletOS	HotWalletOS
Primary use	Secure offline signing	Transaction preparation and broadcasting
Attack surface	Virtually zero	Minimized

Before you begin

Hardware requirements

MonerOS is lightweight and runs on most amd64 (64-bit) hardware, from older laptops to modern workstations. HotWalletOS supports two node types:

- **Self-Sync node:** Runs its own pruned blockchain node. It offers the most privacy but needs stronger hardware and takes several days to finish syncing before you can use it.
- **Remote node:** Connects to an external node. It's ready to use immediately but relies on a third-party node.

ColdWalletOS requirements

Requirement	Minimum
CPU	2+ cores
RAM	1 GB+
Storage space	4 GB+
Storage media	Flash drive, microSD, HDD, or SSD

HotWalletOS requirements

Requirement	Remote node	Self-Sync node
Description	Connects to an external node	Runs its own pruned blockchain node
CPU	2+ cores	2+ cores
RAM	1 GB+	8 GB+
Storage space	4 GB+	250 GB+
Storage media	Any (flash, HDD, or SSD)	SSD only

Note on Self-Sync: A solid-state drive (SSD) is strictly required for Self-Sync. Traditional hard drives (HDDs) can't handle the I/O demands of blockchain synchronization.

Part 1: Set up ColdWalletOS and create a wallet

Complete these steps on ColdWalletOS to create your vault, generate a wallet, and confirm your recovery seed.

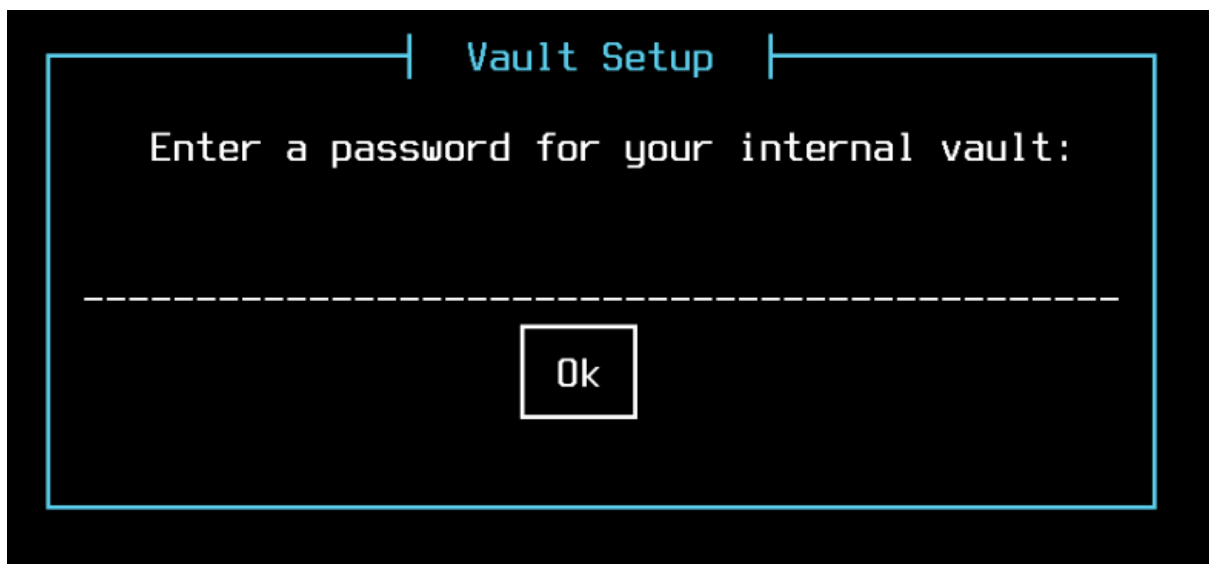
1. Boot into ColdWalletOS. Wait for the prompt to insert HotWalletOS, if it isn't already connected.

```
[ 1.366300] ata1.00: ATA-7: QEMU HARDDISK, 2.5+, max UDMA/100
[ 1.366562] ata1.00: 1796096 sectors, multi 16: LBA48 NCQ (depth 32)
[ 1.366793] ata1.00: applying bridge limits
[ 1.367208] ata2: SATA link down (SStatus 0 SControl 300)
[ 1.367534] ata1.00: configured for UDMA/100
[ 1.368001] scsi 0:0:0:0: Direct-Access    ATA       QEMU HARDDISK   2.5+ PQ: 0 ANSI: 5
[ 1.368258] ata6: SATA link down (SStatus 0 SControl 300)
[ 1.382198] sd 0:0:0:0: [sda] 1796096 512-byte logical blocks: (920 MB/877 MiB)
[ 1.383606] sd 0:0:0:0: [sda] Write Protect is off
[ 1.383878] sd 0:0:0:0: [sda] Write cache: enabled, read cache: enabled, doesn't support DPO or FUA
[ 1.384145] sd 0:0:0:0: [sda] Preferred minimum I/O size 512 bytes
[ 1.385012] sda: sda1 sda2 sda3
[ 1.385664] sd 0:0:0:0: [sda] Attached SCSI disk
Begin: Loading essential drivers ... done.
Begin: Running /scripts/init-premount ... [ 1.563552] usb 1-2: New USB device found, idVendor=0627, idProduct=0001, bcdDevice= 0.00
[ 1.564721] usb 1-2: New USB device strings: Mfr=1, Product=3, SerialNumber=10
[ 1.564943] usb 1-2: Product: QEMU USB Tablet
[ 1.565178] usb 1-2: Manufacturer: QEMU
[ 1.565393] usb 1-2: SerialNumber: 28754-0000:00:02:1:00.0-2
[ 1.572178] hid: raw HID events driver (C) Jiri Kosina
[ 1.580297] usbcore: registered new interface driver usbhid
[ 1.580763] usbhid: USB HID core driver
[ 1.582354] input: QEMU QEMU USB Tablet as /devices/pci0000:00/0000:00:02:1/0000:02:00.0/usb1/1-2/1-2:1.0/0003:0627:0001.0001/input/input4
=====
[ 1.582656] hid-generic 0003:0627:0001.0001: input,hidraw0: USB HID v0.01 Mouse [QEMU QEMU USB Tablet] on usb-0000:02:00.0-2/input0
INSERT HotWalletOS
=====
[ 1.689784] usb 2-5: new SuperSpeed USB device number 2 using xhci_hcd
[ 1.713248] usb 2-5: New USB device found, idVendor=0781, idProduct=55b1, bcdDevice= 1.10
[ 1.713503] usb 2-5: New USB device strings: Mfr=1, Product=2, SerialNumber=3
[ 1.713739] usb 2-5: Product: SanDisk 3.2 Gen1
[ 1.713970] usb 2-5: Manufacturer: SanDisk
[ 1.714196] usb 2-5: SerialNumber: A200366342093036
[ 1.718394] usb-storage 2-5:1.0: USB Mass Storage device detected
[ 1.719788] scsi host6: usb-storage 2-5:1.0
[ 1.720165] usbcore: registered new interface driver usb-storage
[ 1.721727] usbcore: registered new interface driver uas
[ 1.863900] input: ImExPS/2 Generic Explorer Mouse as /devices/platform/i8042/serio1/input/input3
[ 2.735682] scsi 6:0:0:0: Direct-Access    SanDisk   SanDisk 3.2 Gen1 DL17 PQ: 0 ANSI: 6
[ 2.738732] sd 6:0:0:0: [sdb] 977829888 512-byte logical blocks: (501 GB/466 GiB)
[ 2.740163] sd 6:0:0:0: [sdb] Write Protect is off
[ 2.741657] sd 6:0:0:0: [sdb] Write cache: disabled, read cache: enabled, doesn't support DPO or FUA
[ 2.746063] sd 6:0:0:0: [sdb] Attached SCSI removable disk
=====
INSERT HotWalletOS
=====
```

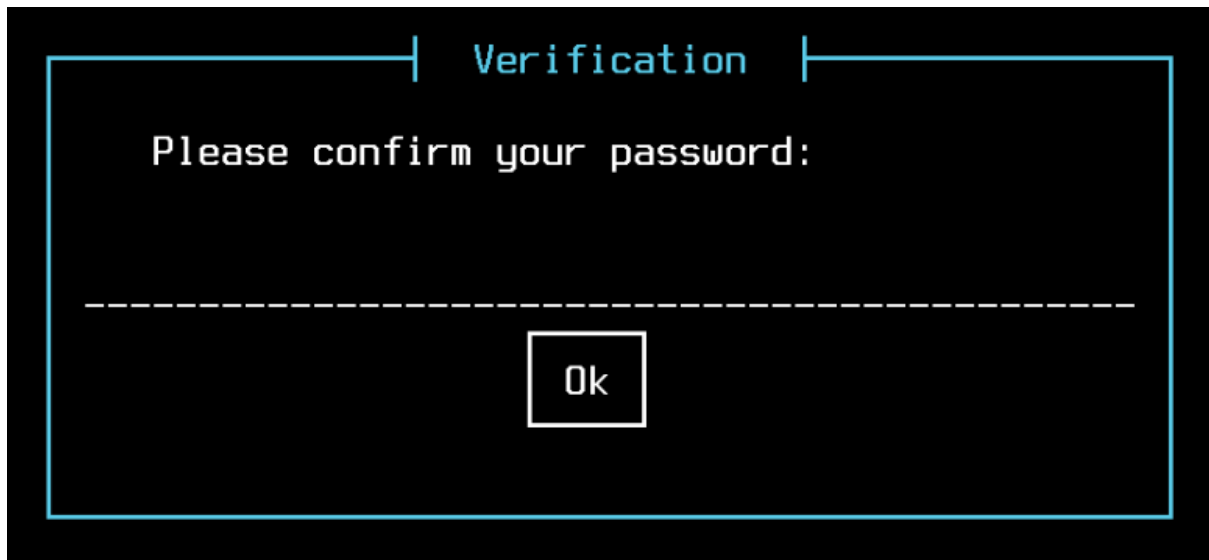
2. Select **Create Vault**.



3. Create a strong password. You'll use this password throughout MonerOS.



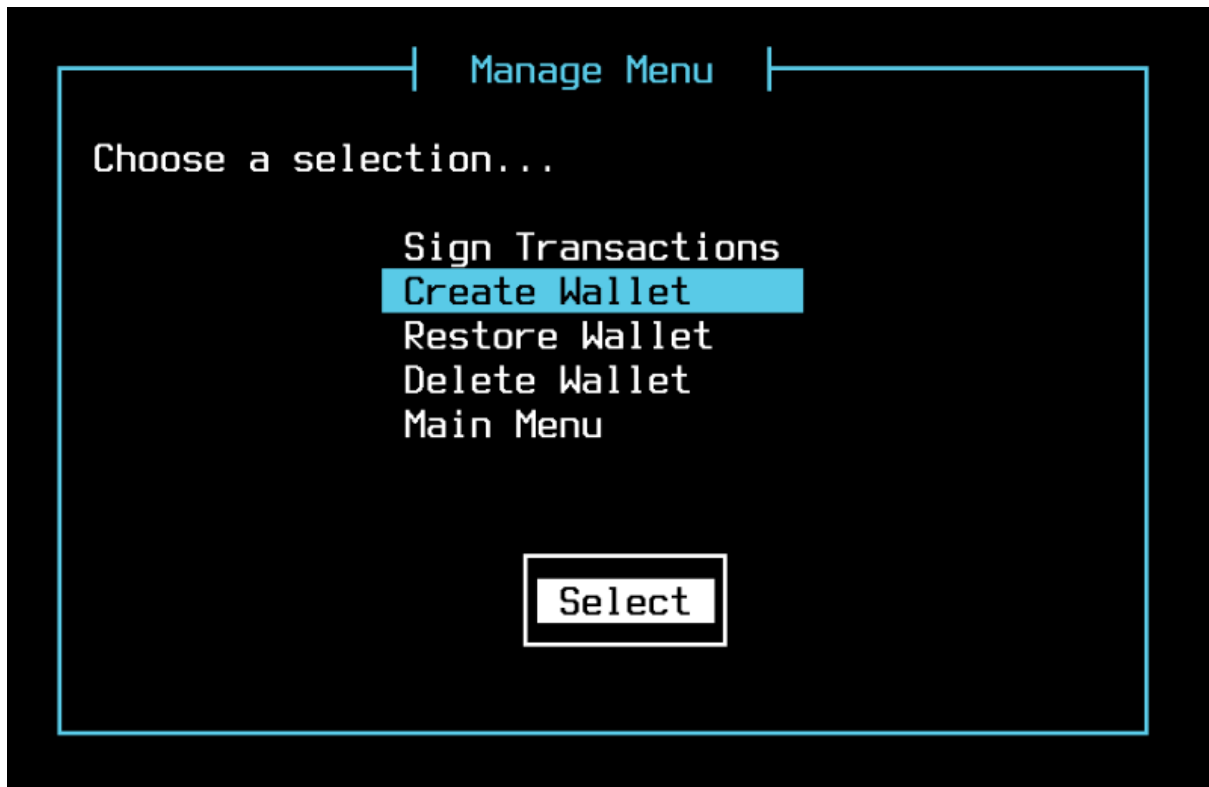
4. Confirm your password.



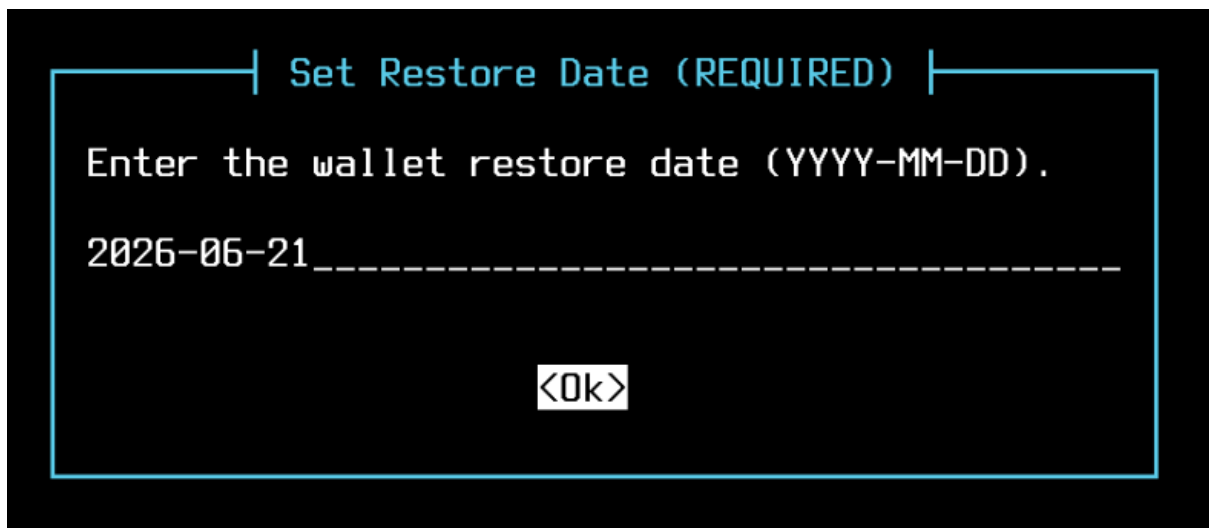
5. Go to **Manage Wallets**.



6. Select **Create Wallet**.



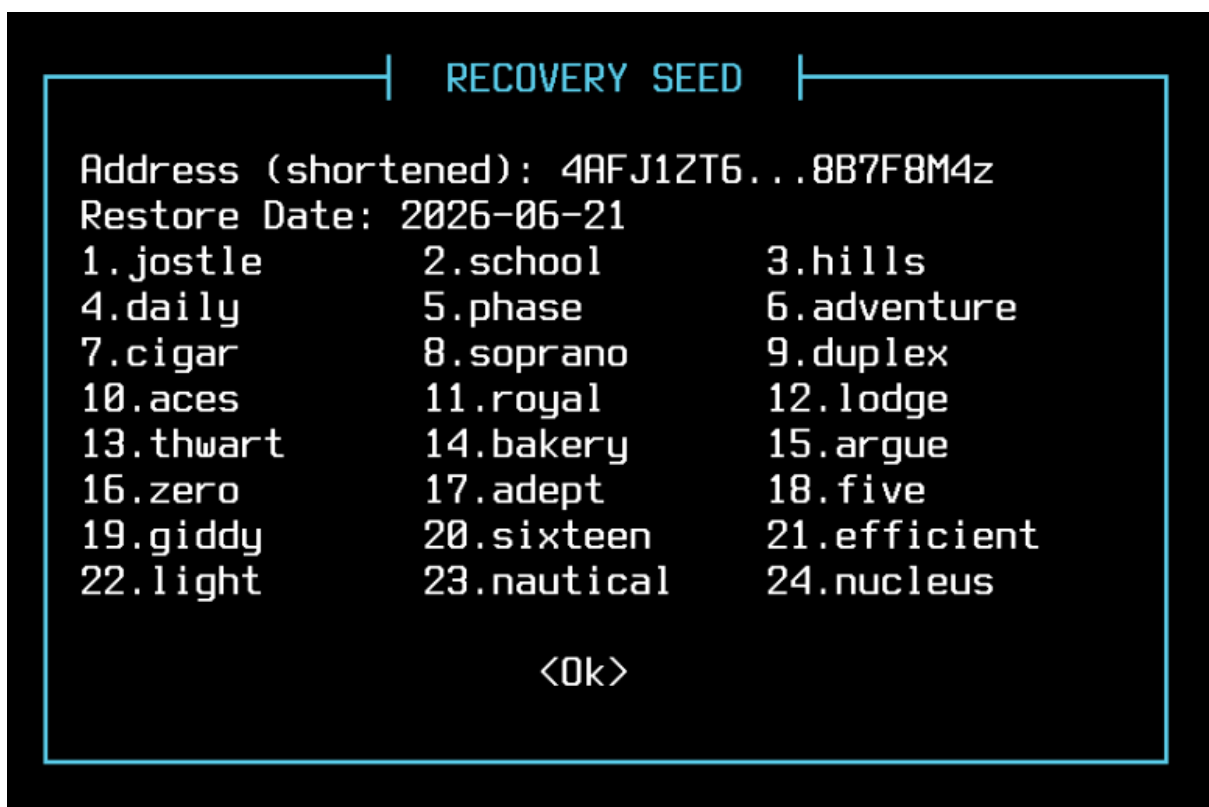
7. Enter the current date. MonerOS uses this date to determine how far back to sync your wallet.



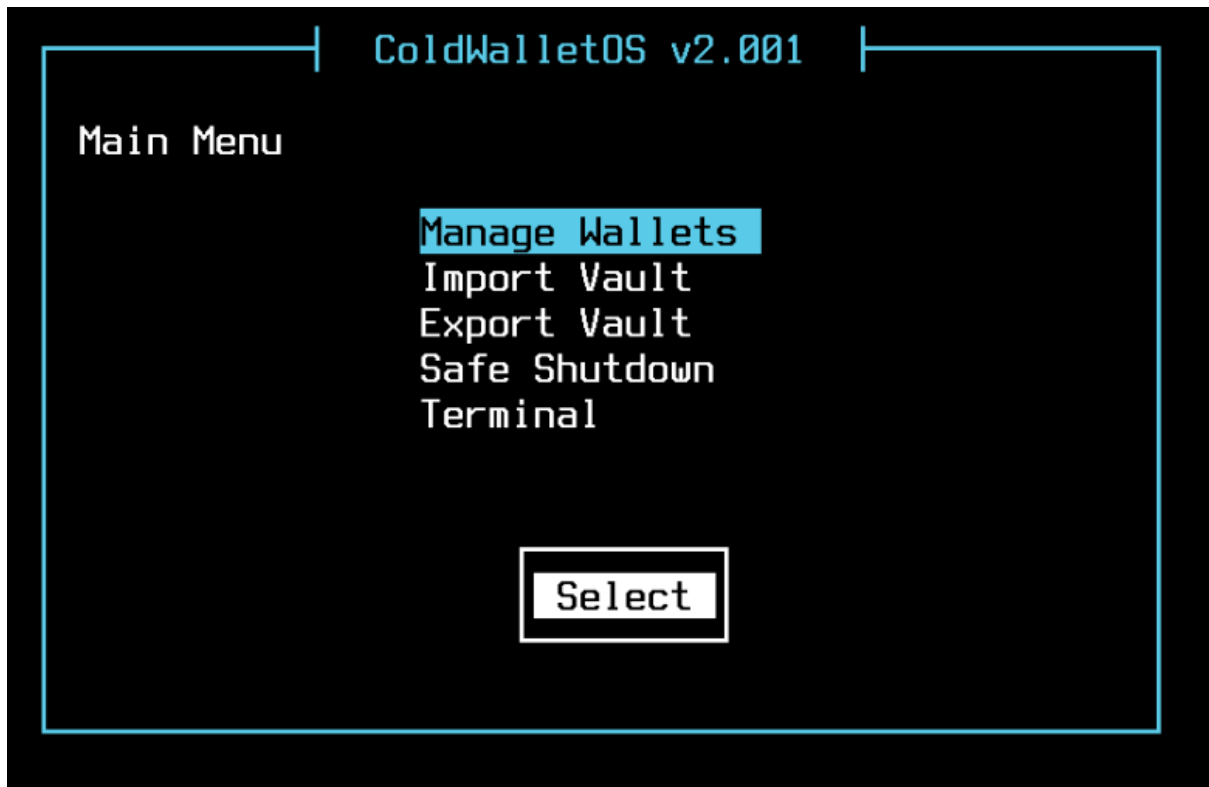
8. MonerOS displays your full wallet address and prompts you to record your recovery seed.



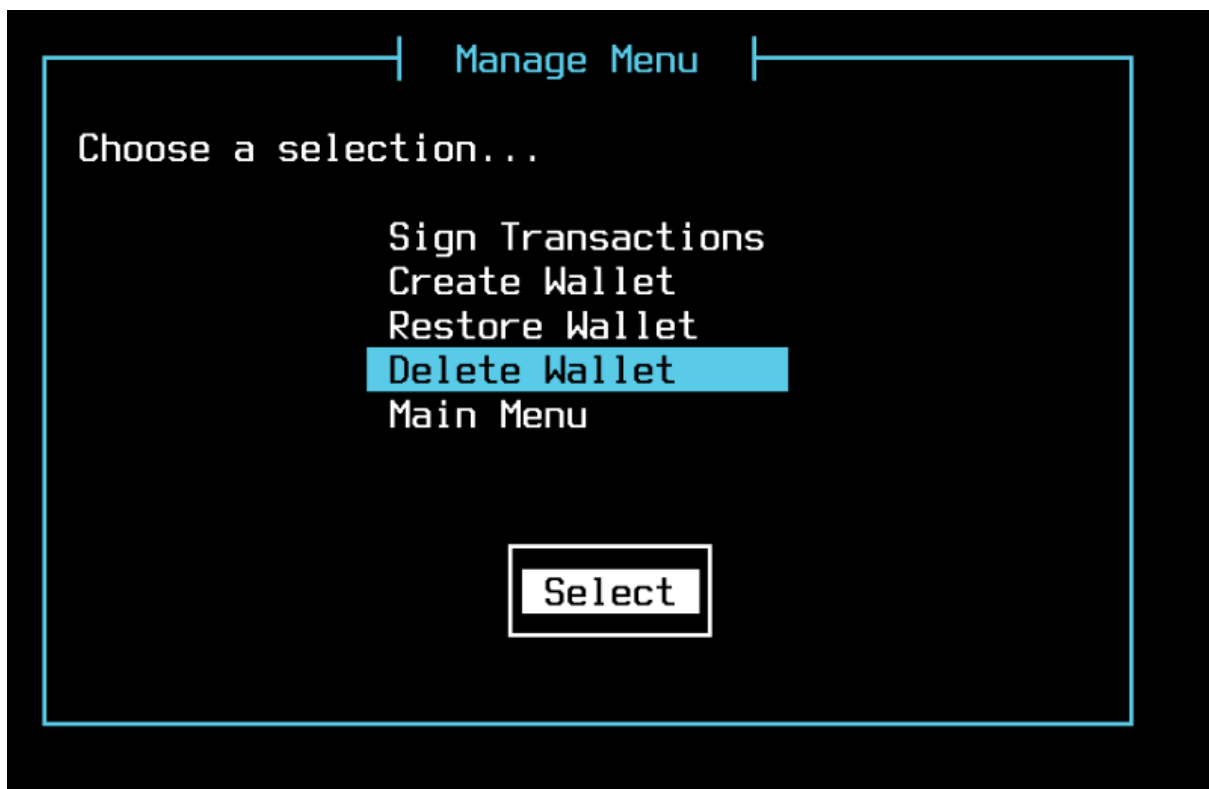
9. Write down your recovery seed and store it somewhere very safe. This seed lets you recover your wallet if you lose access to it, whether from this operating system or virtually any other Monero wallet software.



10. Go to **Manage Wallets** again.



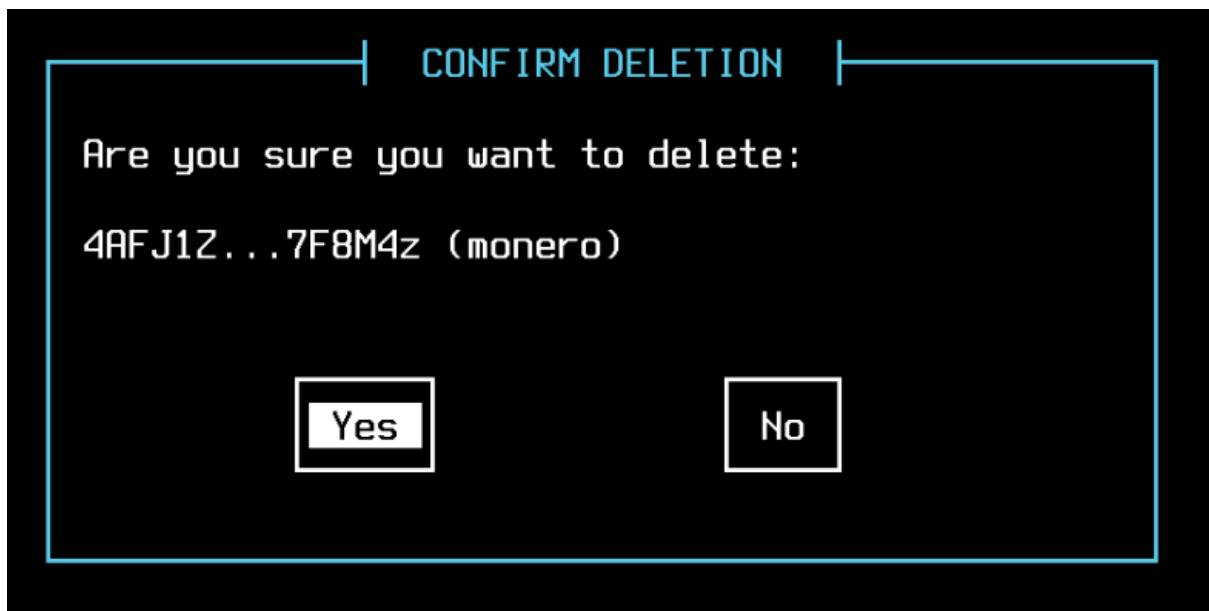
11. Select **Delete Wallet**. Deleting and restoring the wallet lets you confirm that you recorded the seed correctly.



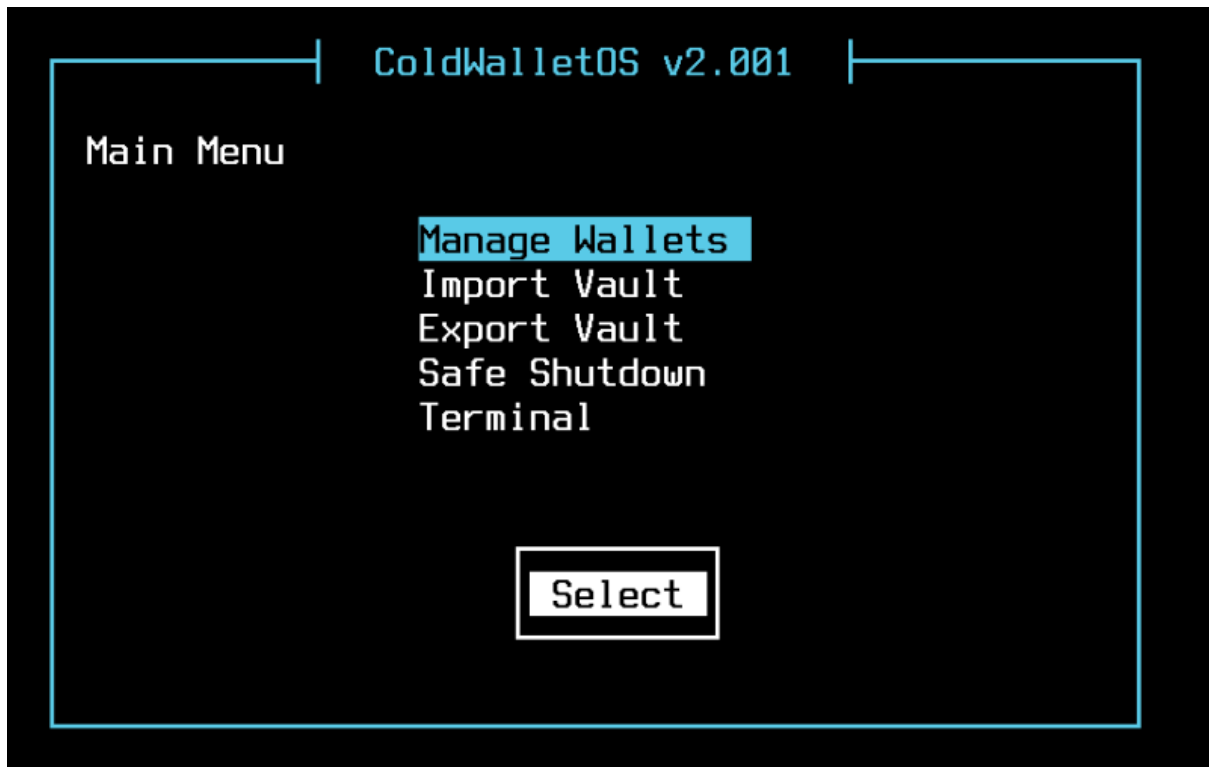
12. If you have multiple wallets, select the correct one.



13. Confirm the deletion.



14. Select **Manage Wallets** again.



15. Select **Restore Wallet**. This confirms that you recorded the recovery seed correctly.



16. Enter words 1 through 24 from your recovery seed.

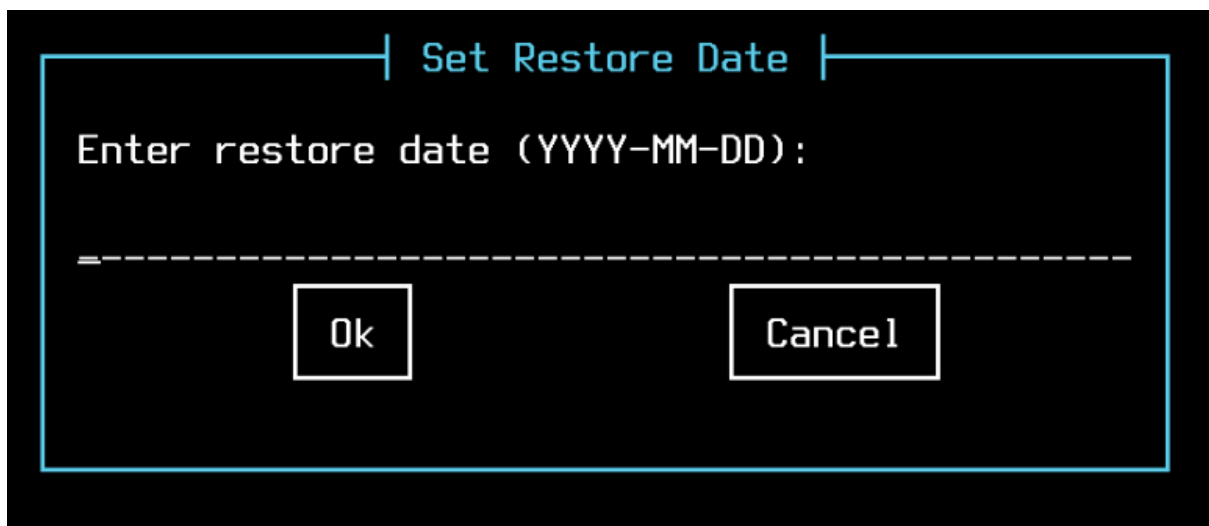


Restore Wallet (Word 1/24)

Enter word 1:

Ok Cancel

17. Enter the restore date.

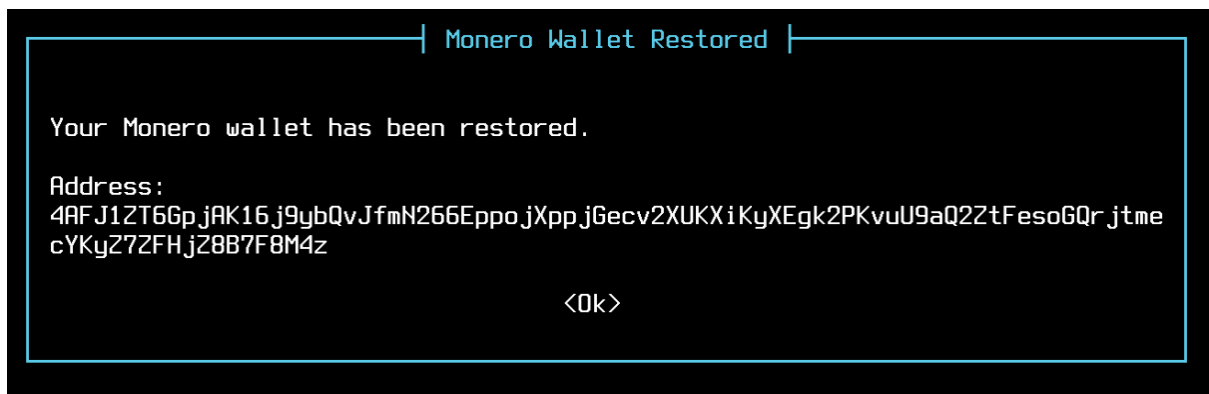


Set Restore Date

Enter restore date (YYYY-MM-DD):

Ok Cancel

18. If you entered everything correctly, MonerOS displays a success message.



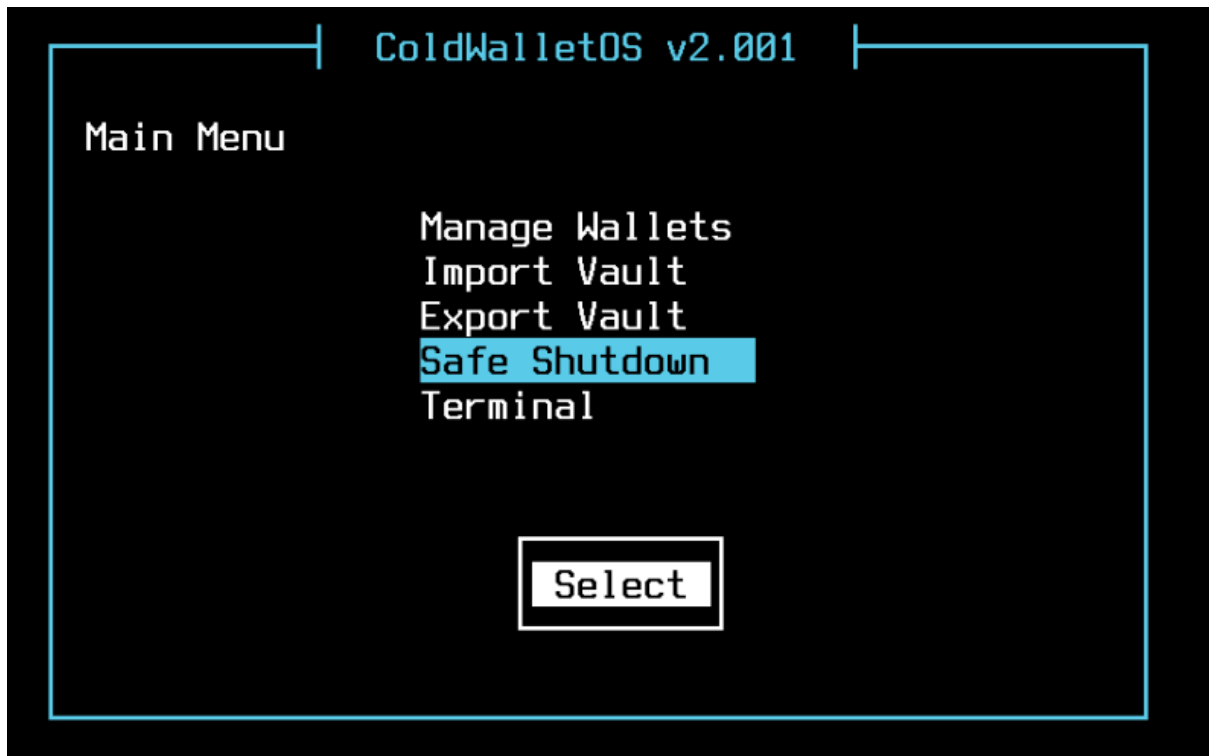
Monero Wallet Restored

Your Monero wallet has been restored.

Address:
4AFJ1ZT6GpjAK16j9ybQvJfmN266EppoJXppjGecv2XUKXiKyXEgk2PKvuU9aQ2ZtFeso6Qrjtme
cYKyZ7ZFHjZ8B7F8M4z

<Ok>

19. Shut down the system and remove the ColdWalletOS disk.



Part 2: Start HotWalletOS

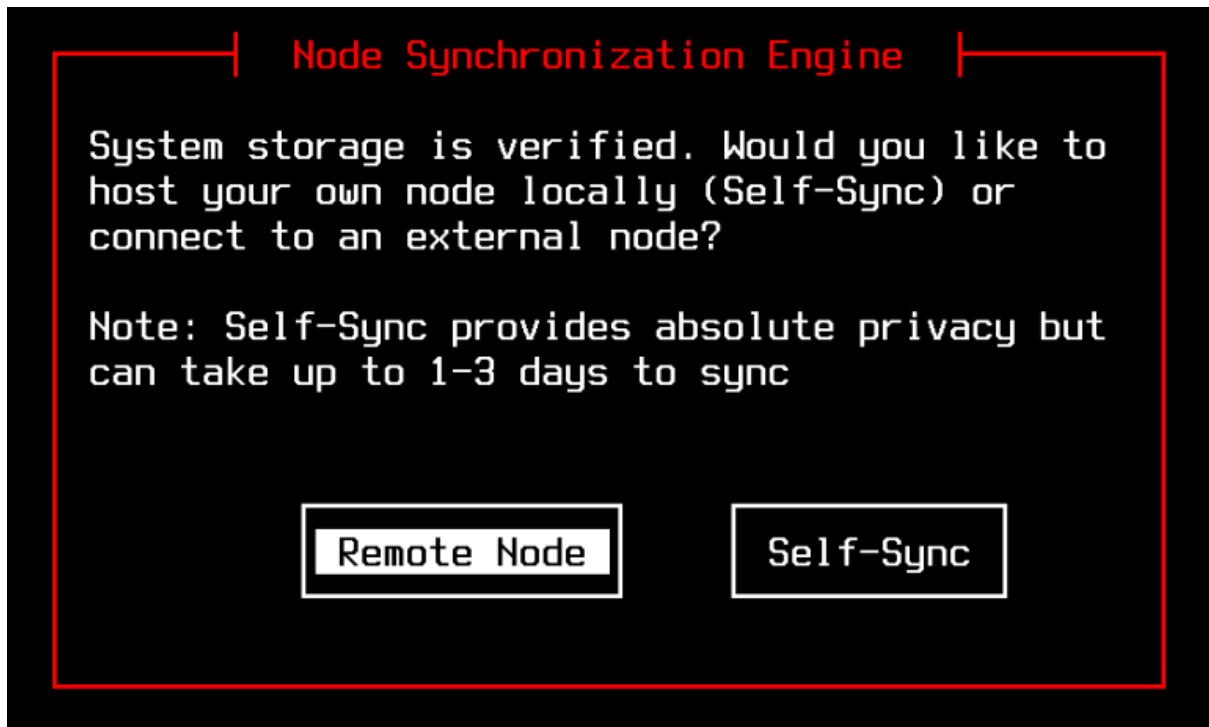
Complete these steps to boot HotWalletOS and connect it to the Monero network.

1. Make sure ColdWalletOS is not plugged in. Boot HotWalletOS and enter your password.

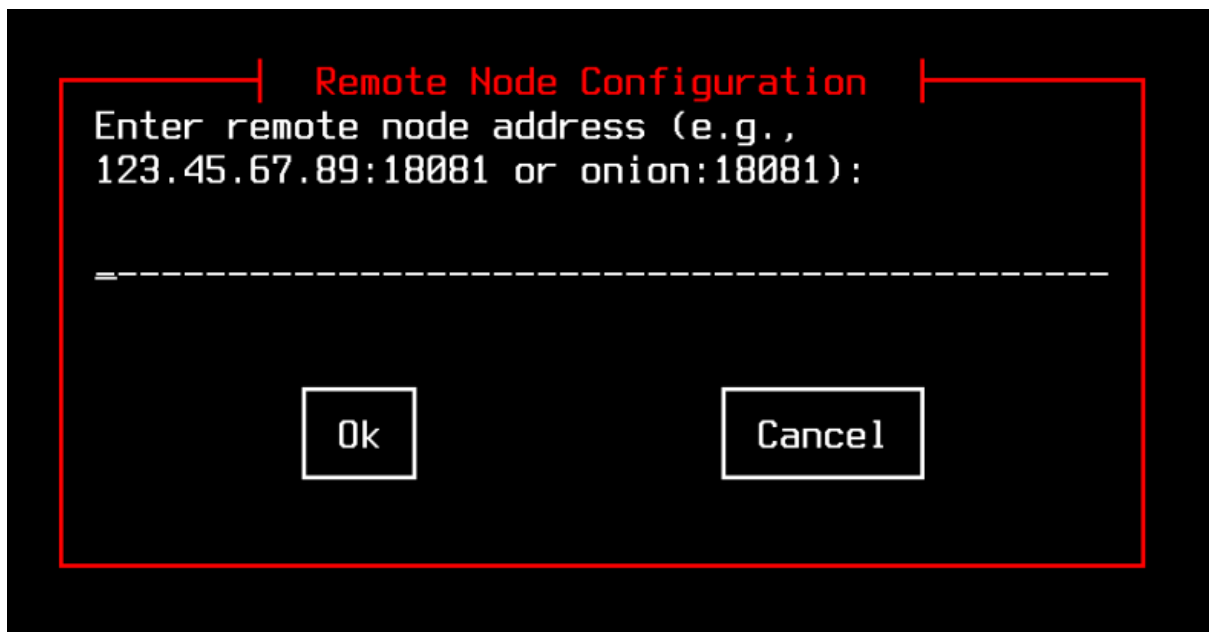


2. Choose whether to use a Remote Node or Self-Sync. This prompt appears on every boot.

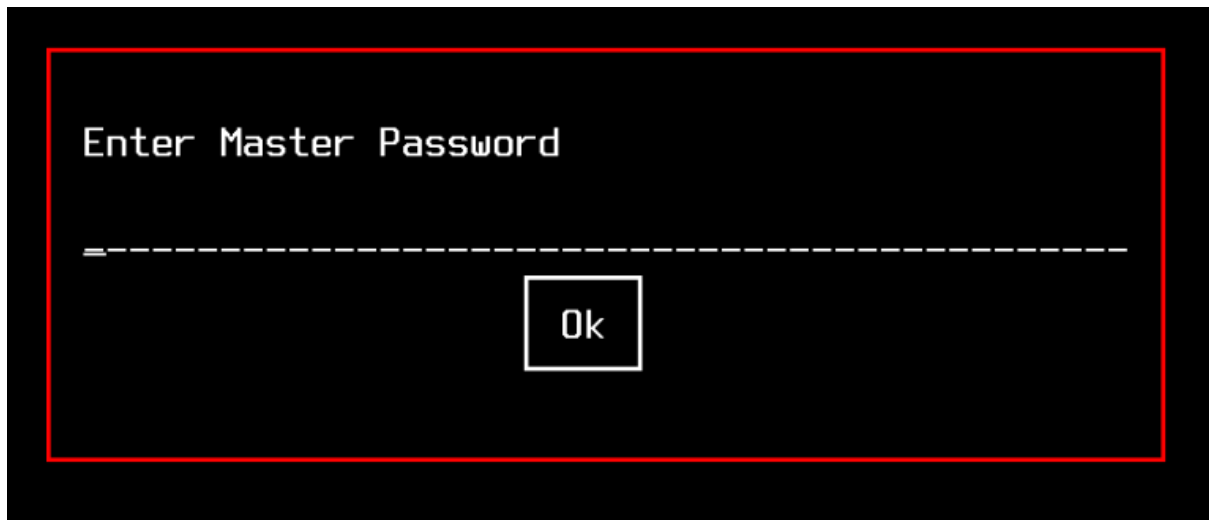
Note: Self-sync requires a disk with at least 250 GB, and that disk must be an SSD. If the disk is not an SSD, do not select Self-Sync. Flash drives and HDDs aren't fast enough to keep up with blockchain syncing.



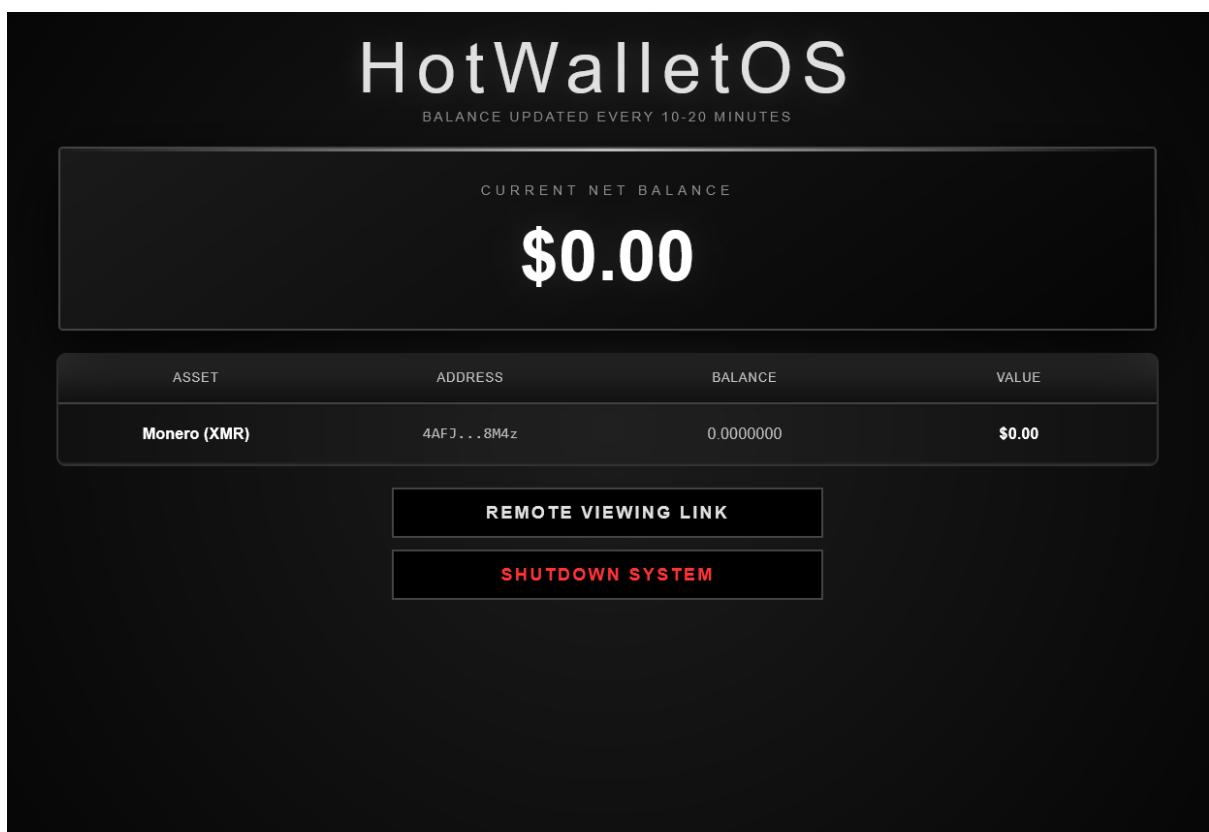
3. If you choose a remote node, enter its address **without `http://` or `https://`**. Visit <https://monero.fail> to find clearnet or onion nodes and view information about them.



4. Enter your password two more times as the system finishes setup. This extra step is inconvenient but necessary for security.



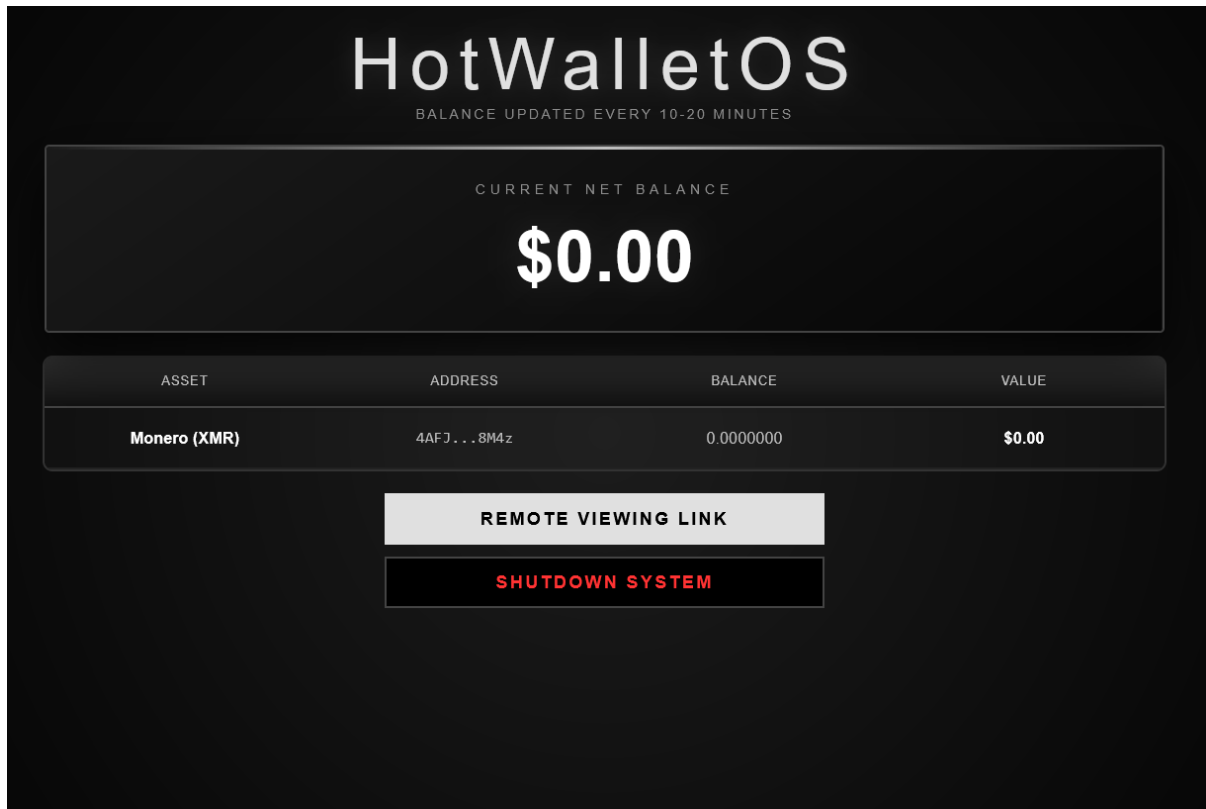
5. If setup succeeds, MonerOS displays your wallet(s) and balance(s).



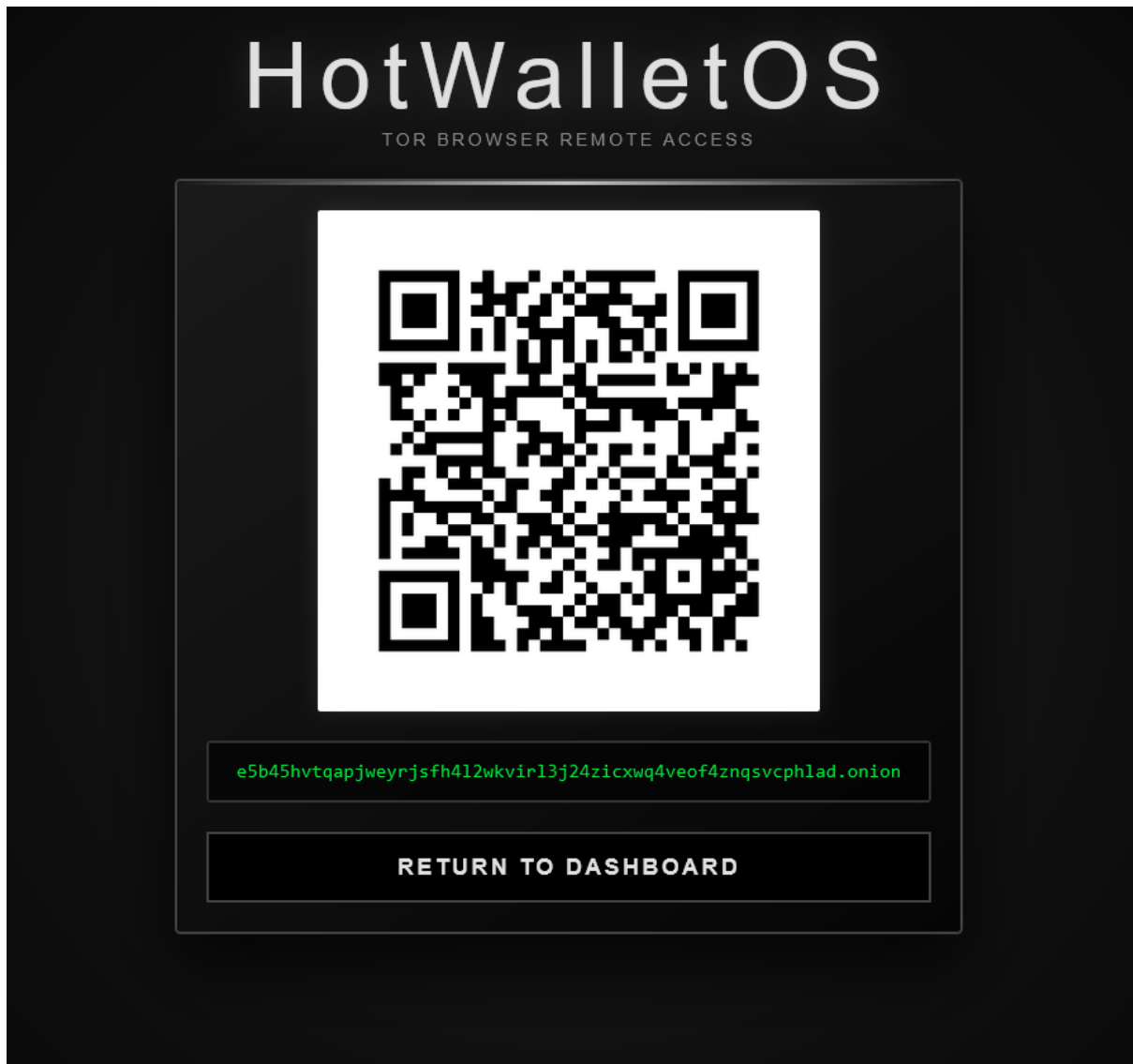
Part 3: Receive and send funds

Access HotWalletOS remotely

1. With the system running, you can access it from any Tor Browser. Select **Remote Viewing Link** to get your Tor address.

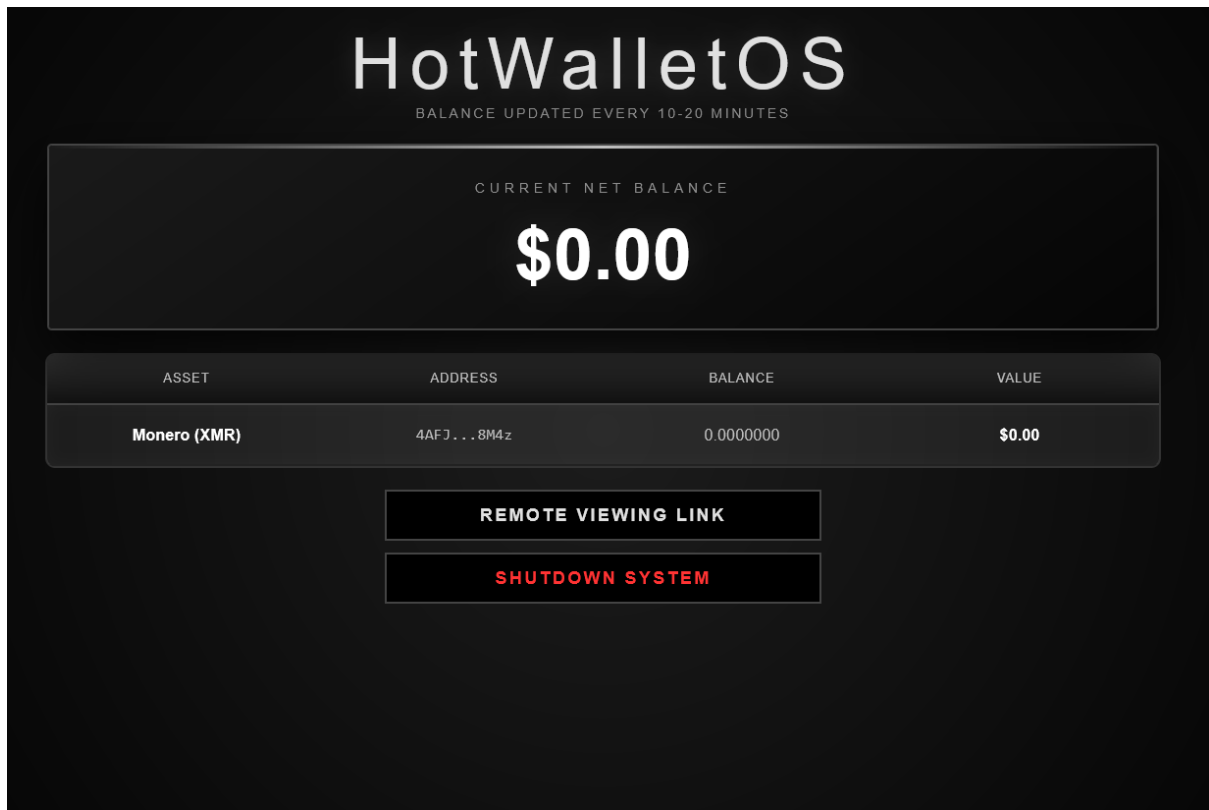


2. Copy the onion address, or scan the QR code with a mobile device (see Part 6).



Receive funds

3. To get your full Monero address, select the wallet you want from the main screen.



4. Double-click **Transfer From Address** to copy it, then you can share that address to receive funds to your wallet.

HotWalletOS

MONERO TRANSFER

TRANSFER FROM ADDRESS (READ-ONLY)

4AFJ1ZT6GpjAK16j9ybQvJfmN266EppoJXppjGecv2XUKXiKyXEgk2PKv

TRANSFER TO ADDRESS

UNLOCKED XMR BALANCE (READ-ONLY)

0.000000000000

TRANSFER AMOUNT IN XMR (OR SWEEP_ALL)

DEVELOPMENT CONTRIBUTION

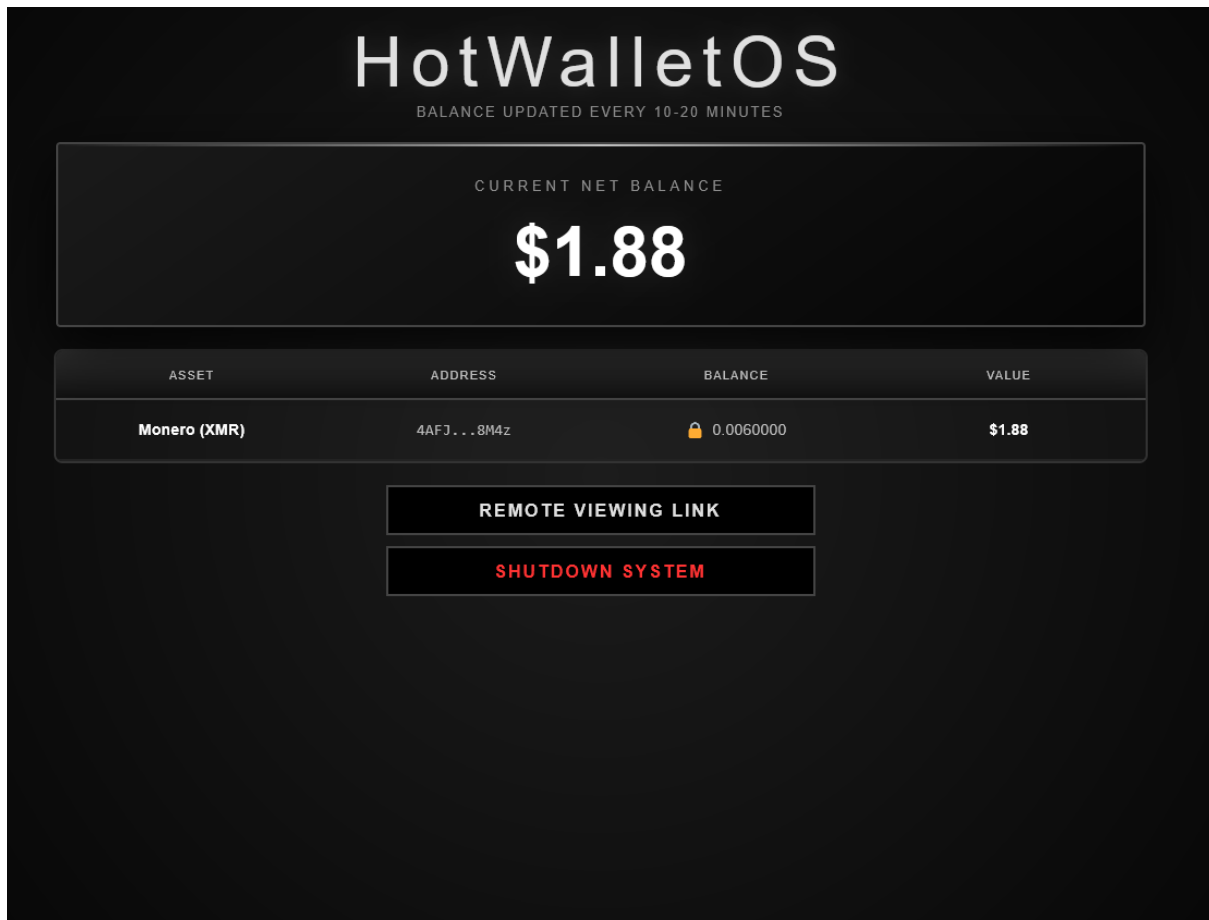
0.40% (Recommended)

WALLET PASSWORD

CREATE UNSIGNED TRANSACTION

CANCEL AND GO BACK

5. When funds arrive, a locked icon appears next to the address. Monero transactions take about 20 minutes to unlock.



6. Select the address to view your unlocked balance. Only the pending transaction is locked - any balance that was already unlocked stays available.

HotWalletOS

MONERO TRANSFER

TRANSFER FROM ADDRESS (READ-ONLY)

4AFJ1ZT6GpjAK16j9ybQvJfmN266EppoJXppjGecv2XUKXiKyXEgk2PKv

TRANSFER TO ADDRESS

UNLOCKED XMR BALANCE (READ-ONLY)

0.000000000000

TRANSFER AMOUNT IN XMR (OR SWEEP_ALL)

DEVELOPMENT CONTRIBUTION

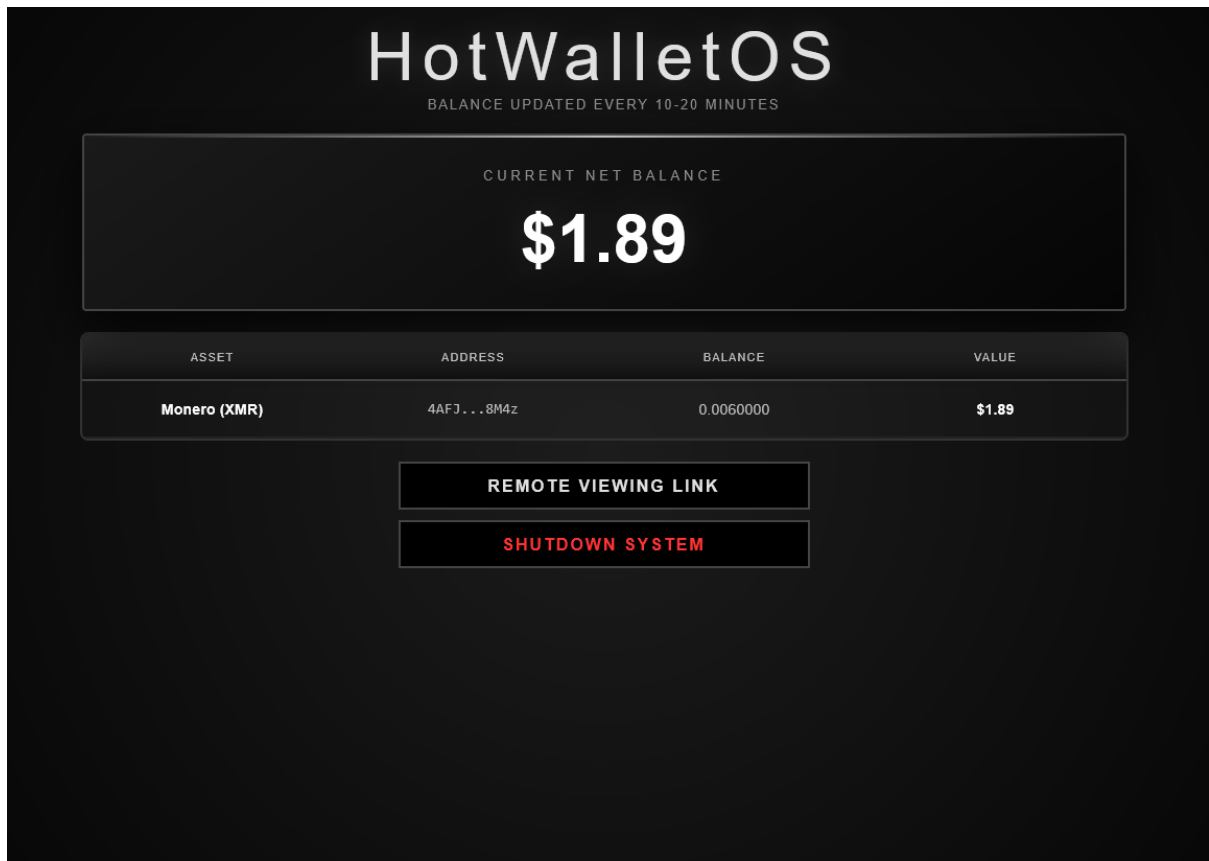
0.40% (Recommended)

WALLET PASSWORD

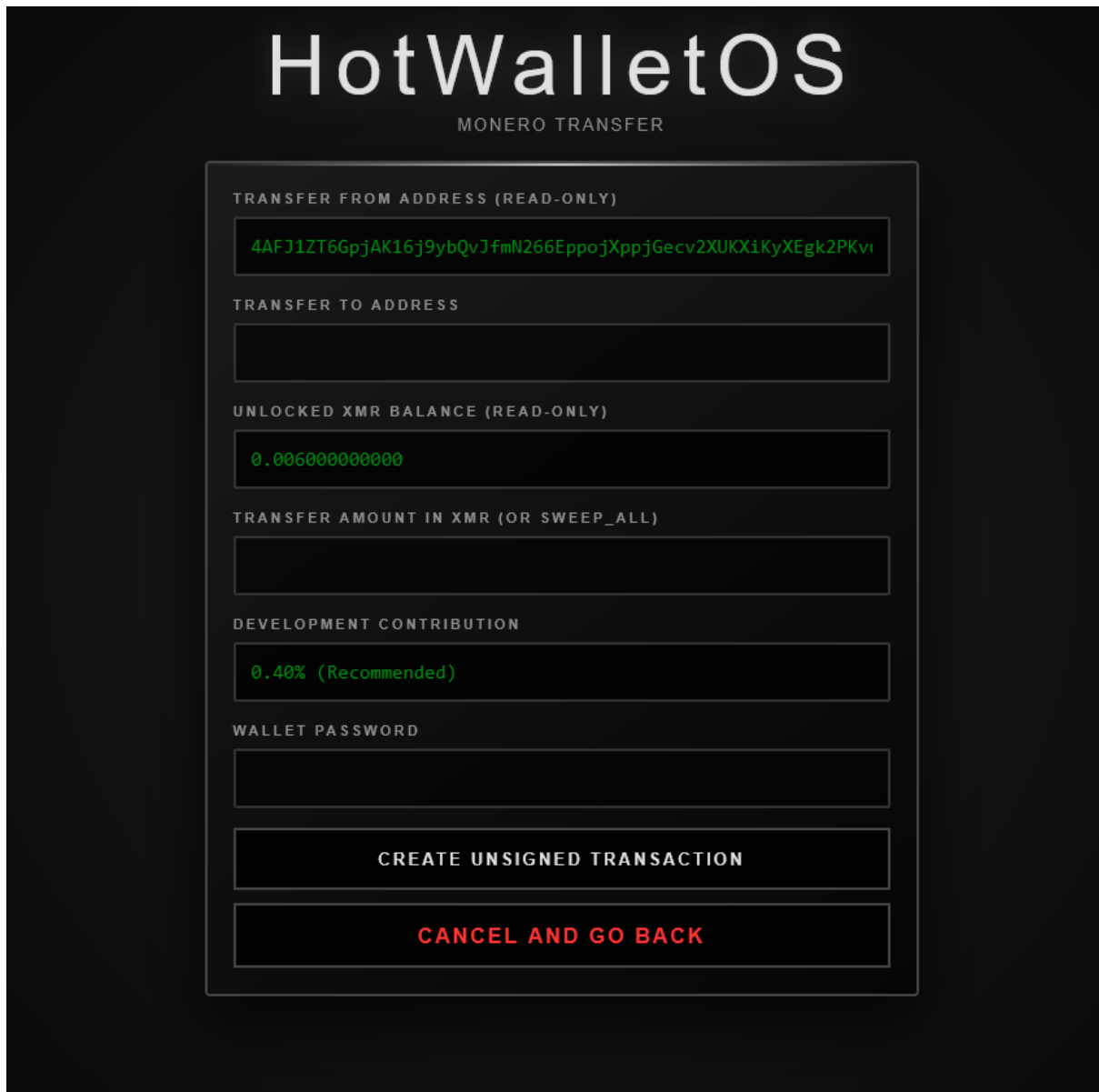
CREATE UNSIGNED TRANSACTION

CANCEL AND GO BACK

7. Once the transaction unlocks, the padlock icon disappears.



8. You can also check unlock status by selecting the wallet.



The image shows a dark-themed web interface for 'HotWalletOS MONERO TRANSFER'. The title 'HotWalletOS' is at the top in large white font, with 'MONERO TRANSFER' below it in smaller white font. The interface contains several input fields and buttons. The first field is 'TRANSFER FROM ADDRESS (READ-ONLY)' with a green value '4AFJ1ZT6GpjAK16j9ybQvJfmN266EppojXppjGecv2XUKXiKyXEgk2PKvi'. The second field is 'TRANSFER TO ADDRESS' which is empty. The third field is 'UNLOCKED XMR BALANCE (READ-ONLY)' with a green value '0.006000000000'. The fourth field is 'TRANSFER AMOUNT IN XMR (OR SWEEP_ALL)' which is empty. The fifth field is 'DEVELOPMENT CONTRIBUTION' with a green value '0.40% (Recommended)'. The sixth field is 'WALLET PASSWORD' which is empty. Below these fields are two buttons: 'CREATE UNSIGNED TRANSACTION' and 'CANCEL AND GO BACK'.

HotWalletOS

MONERO TRANSFER

TRANSFER FROM ADDRESS (READ-ONLY)

4AFJ1ZT6GpjAK16j9ybQvJfmN266EppojXppjGecv2XUKXiKyXEgk2PKvi

TRANSFER TO ADDRESS

UNLOCKED XMR BALANCE (READ-ONLY)

0.006000000000

TRANSFER AMOUNT IN XMR (OR SWEEP_ALL)

DEVELOPMENT CONTRIBUTION

0.40% (Recommended)

WALLET PASSWORD

CREATE UNSIGNED TRANSACTION

CANCEL AND GO BACK

Send funds

9. Enter an amount to transfer, or type sweep_all to transfer the entire wallet balance to another address. MonerOS calculates fees automatically.

HotWalletOS

MONERO TRANSFER

TRANSFER FROM ADDRESS (READ-ONLY)

4AFJ1ZT6GpjAK16j9ybQvJfmN266EppojXppjGecv2XUKXiKyXEgk2PKvi

TRANSFER TO ADDRESS

UNLOCKED XMR BALANCE (READ-ONLY)

0.006000000000

TRANSFER AMOUNT IN XMR (OR SWEEP_ALL)

0.0051

DEVELOPMENT CONTRIBUTION

0.40% (Recommended)

WALLET PASSWORD

CREATE UNSIGNED TRANSACTION

CANCEL AND GO BACK

HotWalletOS

MONERO TRANSFER

TRANSFER FROM ADDRESS (READ-ONLY)

4AFJ1ZT6GpjAK16j9ybQvJfmN266EppoJXppjGecv2XUKXiKyXEgk2PKvi

TRANSFER TO ADDRESS

UNLOCKED XMR BALANCE (READ-ONLY)

0.006000000000

TRANSFER AMOUNT IN XMR (OR SWEEP_ALL)

sweep_all

DEVELOPMENT CONTRIBUTION

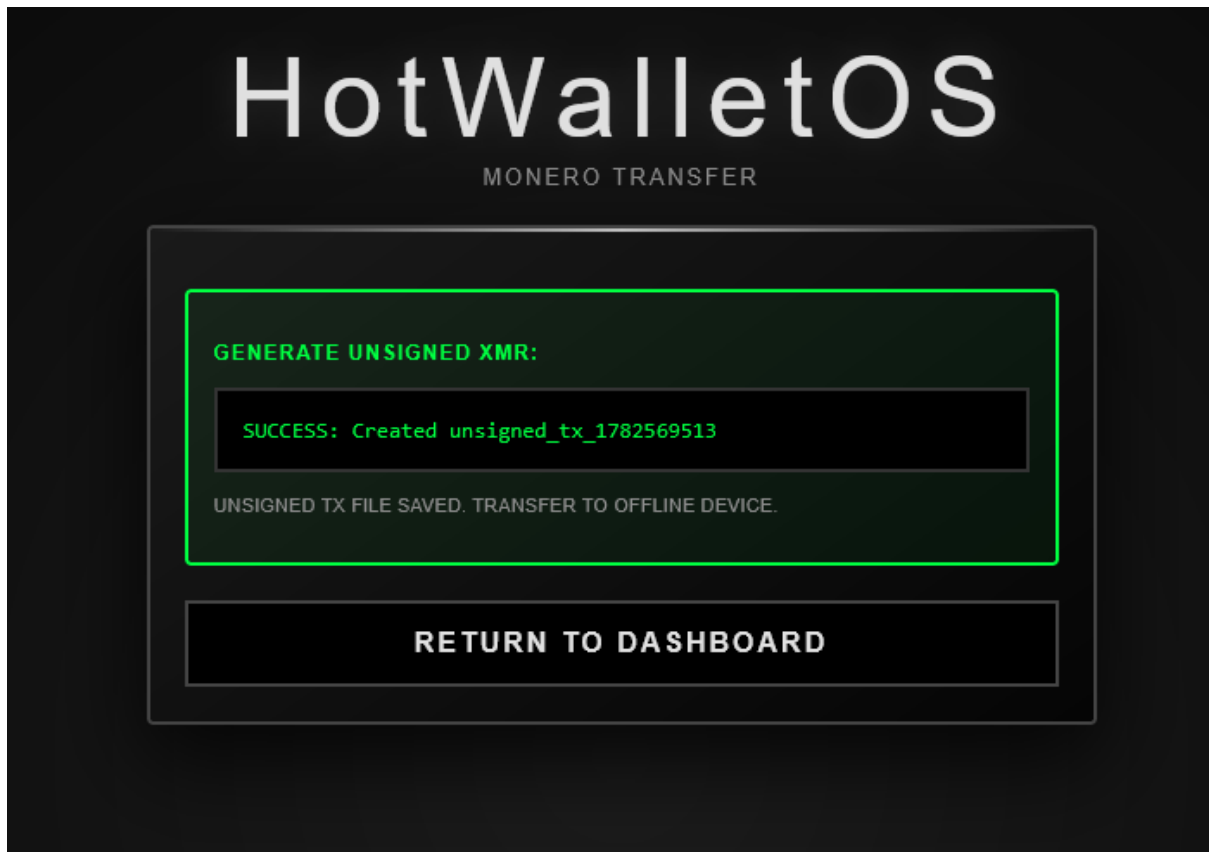
0.40% (Recommended)

WALLET PASSWORD

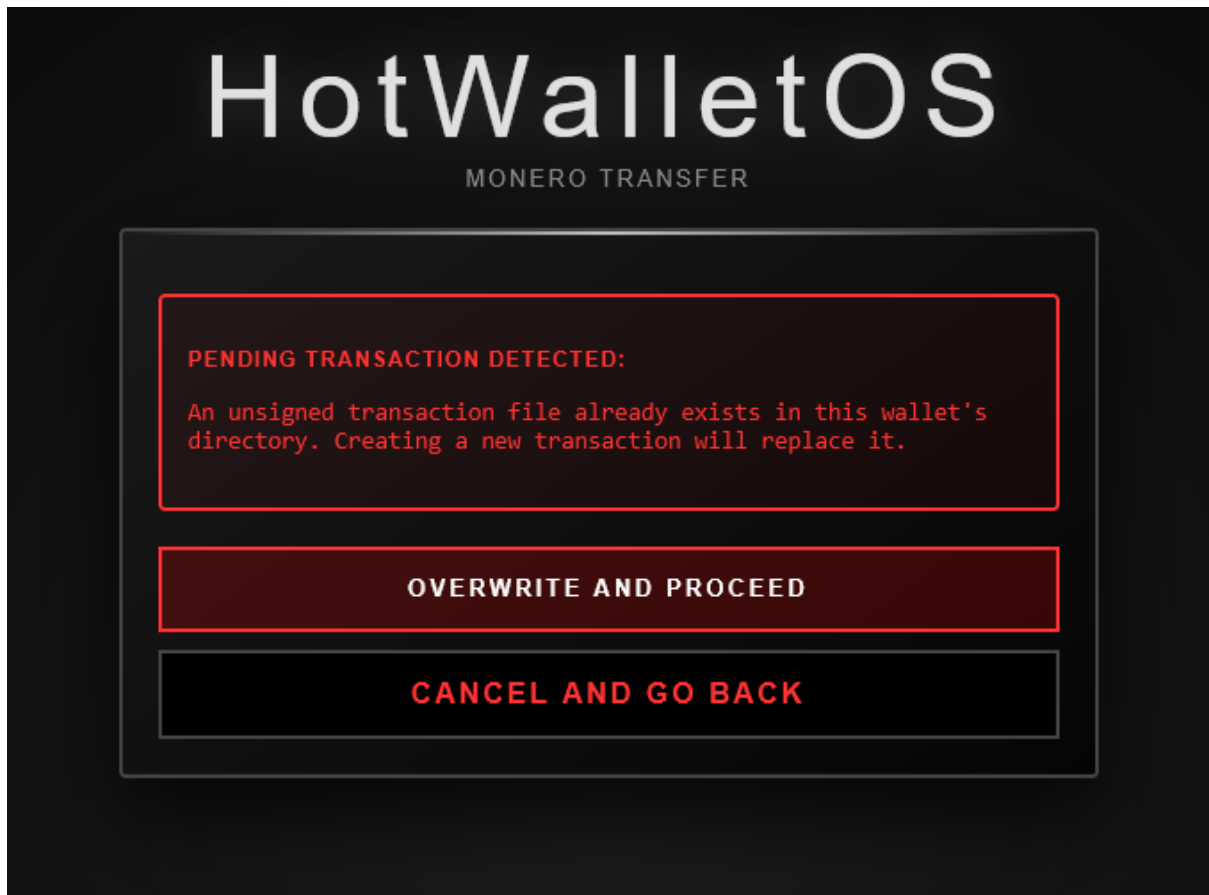
CREATE UNSIGNED TRANSACTION

CANCEL AND GO BACK

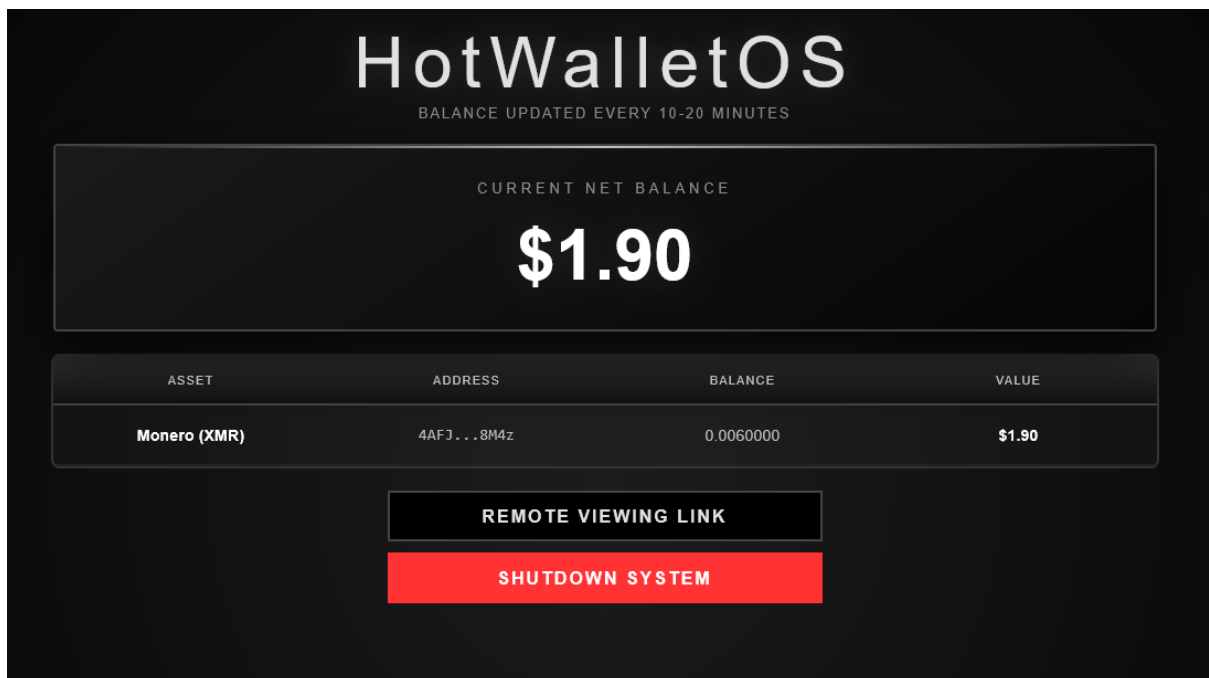
10. Fill in the required fields and select **Create Unsigned Transaction**. MonerOS displays a success message.



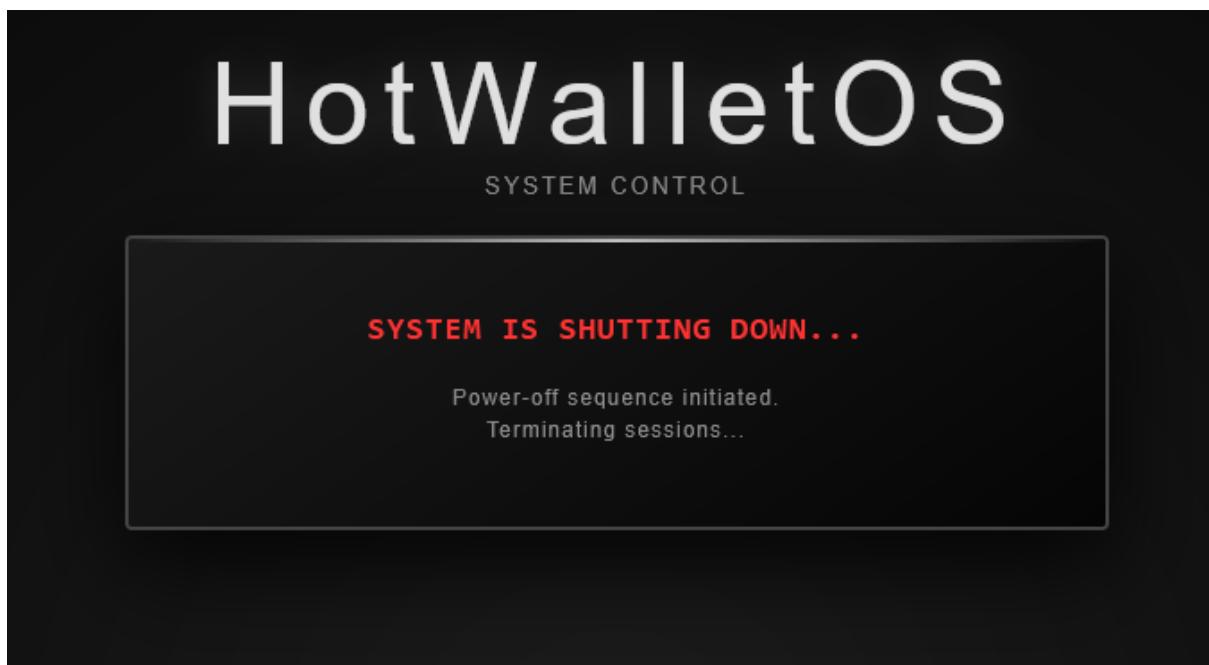
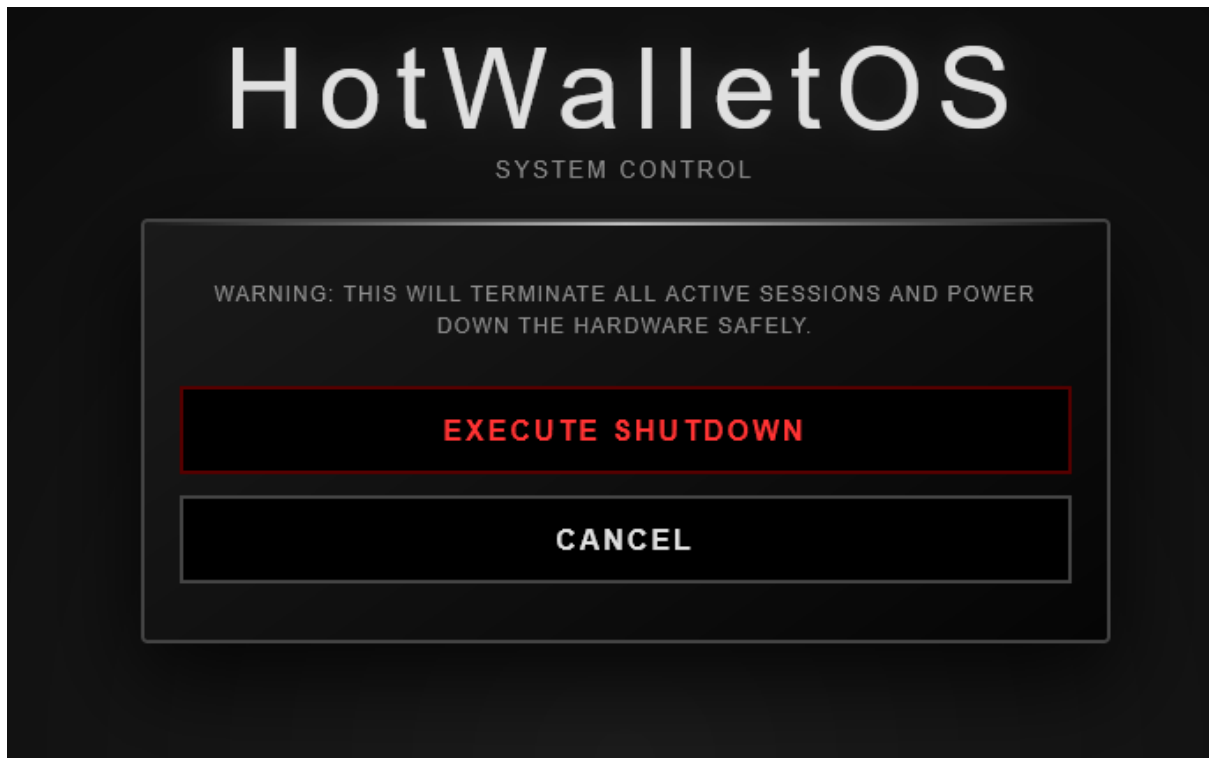
11. Cold wallets can process only one transaction at a time. If you create a new one before signing and submitting the previous transaction, MonerOS asks whether you want to overwrite it.



12. Return to the dashboard and select **Shutdown System** so you can sign the transaction with ColdWalletOS.

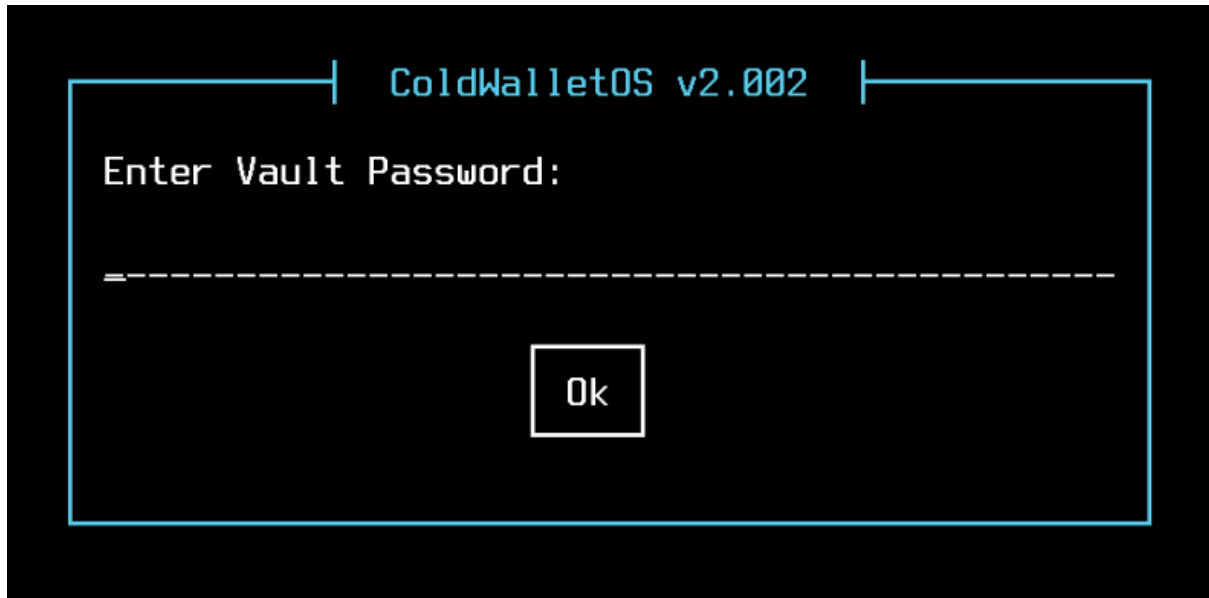


13. Confirm the shutdown.

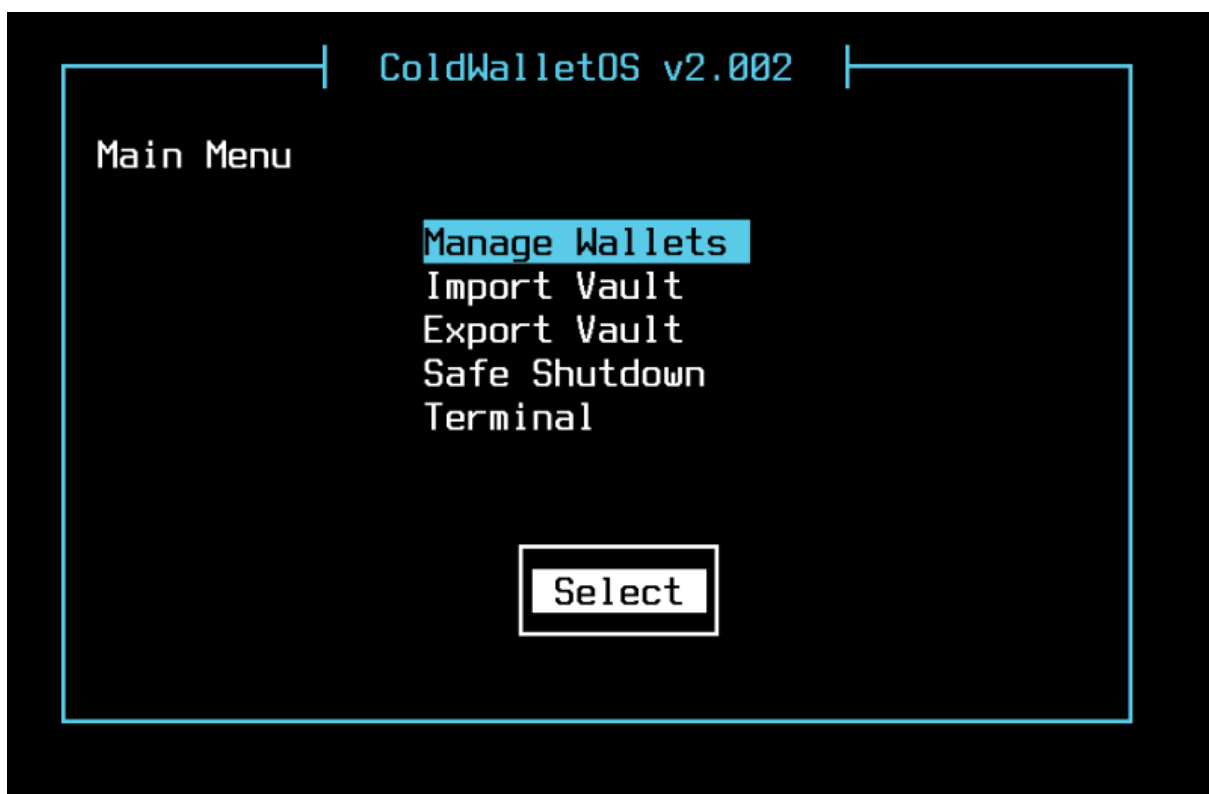


Part 4: Sign a transaction with ColdWalletOS

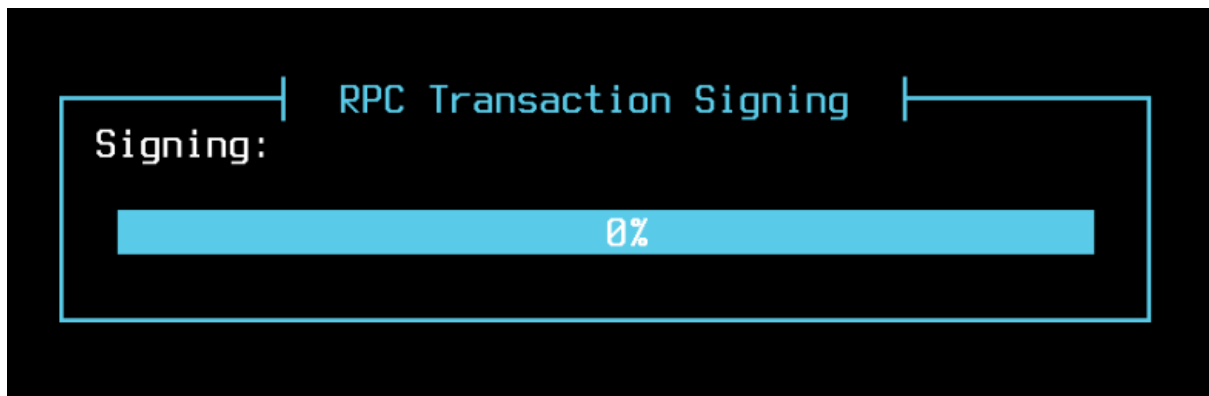
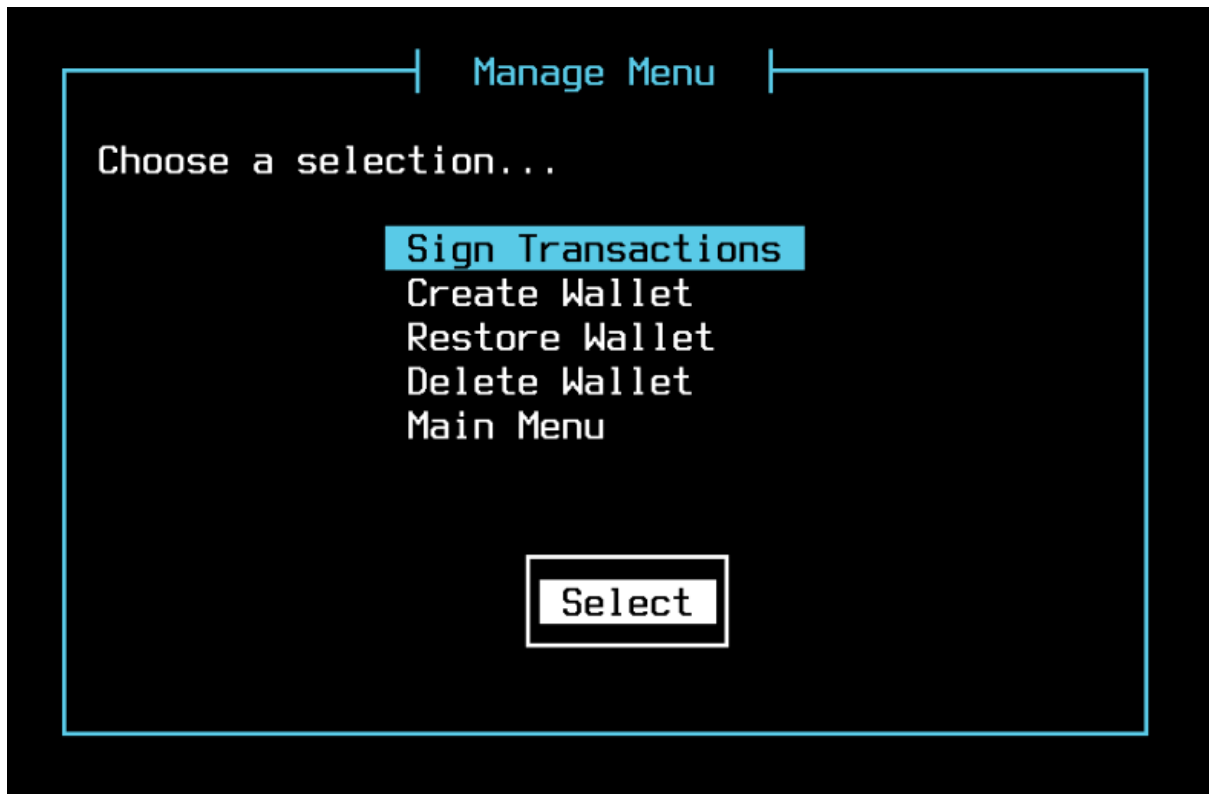
1. Insert ColdWalletOS, boot from it, and enter your password.



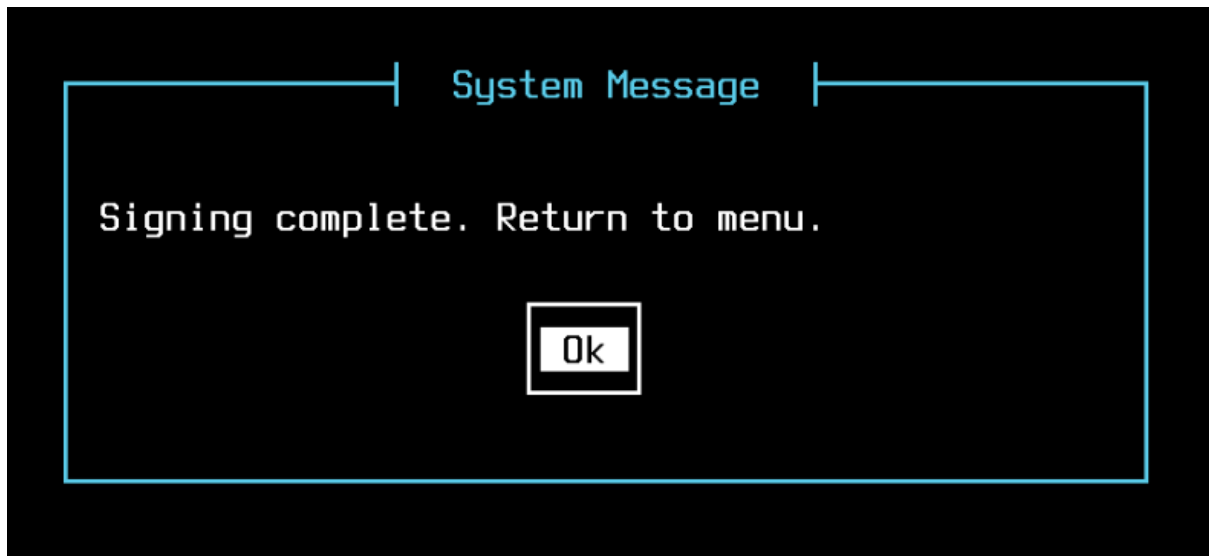
2. Select **Manage Wallets**.



3. Select **Sign Transactions**.

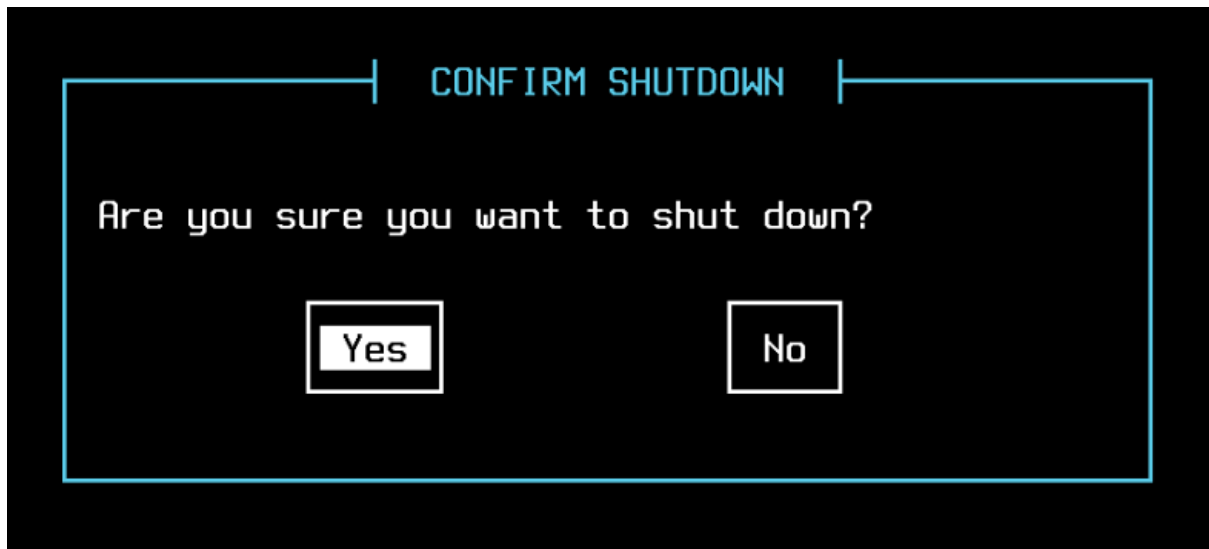


4. After signing finishes, return to the menu.



5. Shut down ColdWalletOS so you can submit the transaction with HotWalletOS.



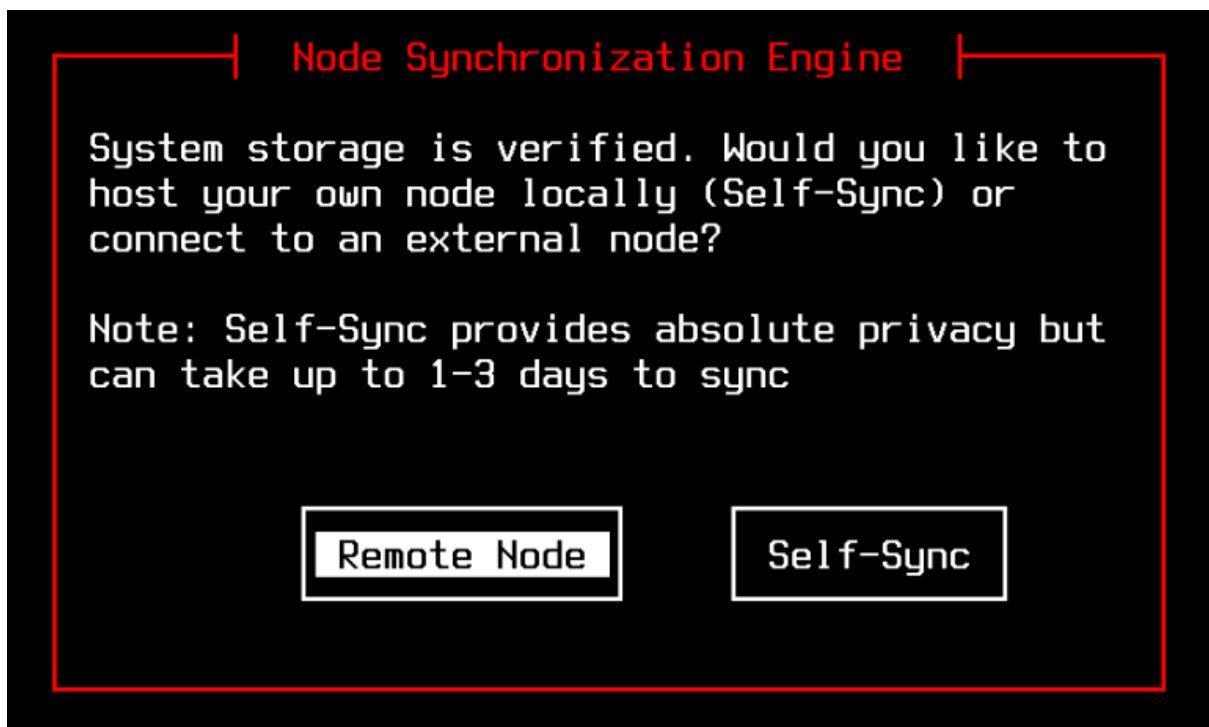


Part 5: Submit a transaction with HotWalletOS

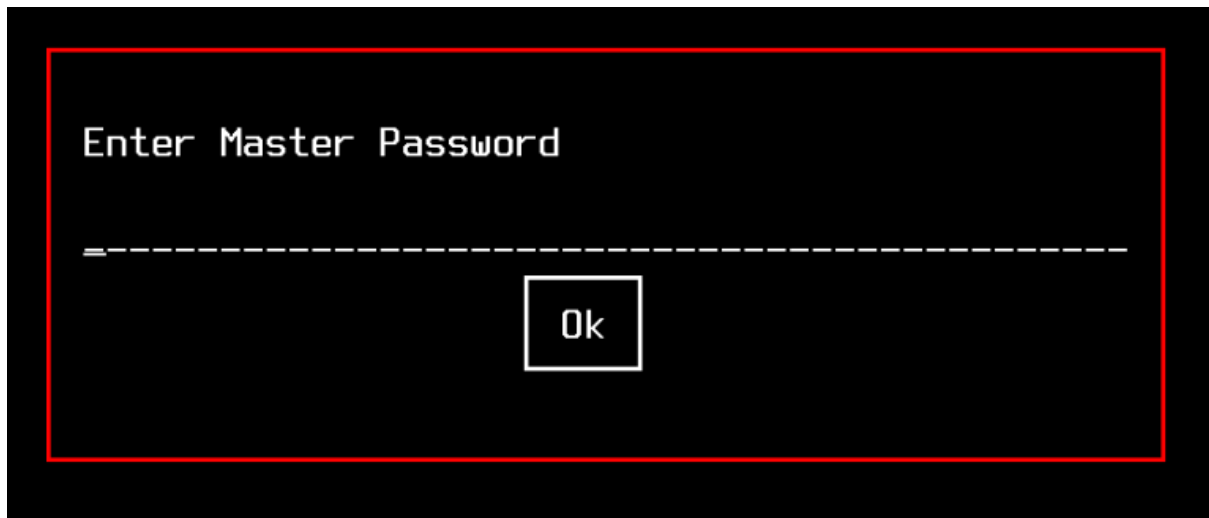
1. Remove ColdWalletOS, boot HotWalletOS, and enter your password.



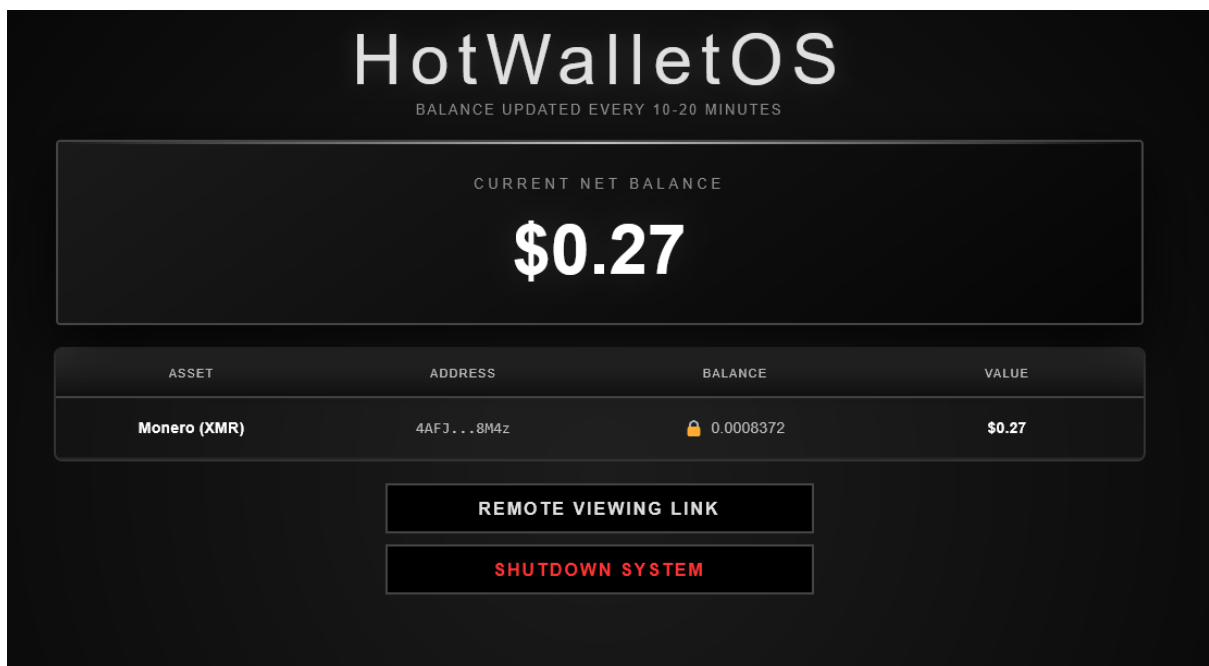
2. Select your node option again.



3. Enter your password two more times as the prompts appear.



4. MonerOS submits your transaction automatically. Some or all of your balance remains locked for about 20 minutes.



5. Once the transaction unlocks, the padlock icon is removed.

HotWalletOS

BALANCE UPDATED EVERY 10-20 MINUTES

CURRENT NET BALANCE

\$0.26

ASSET	ADDRESS	BALANCE	VALUE
Monero (XMR)	4AFJ...8M4z	0.0008372	\$0.26

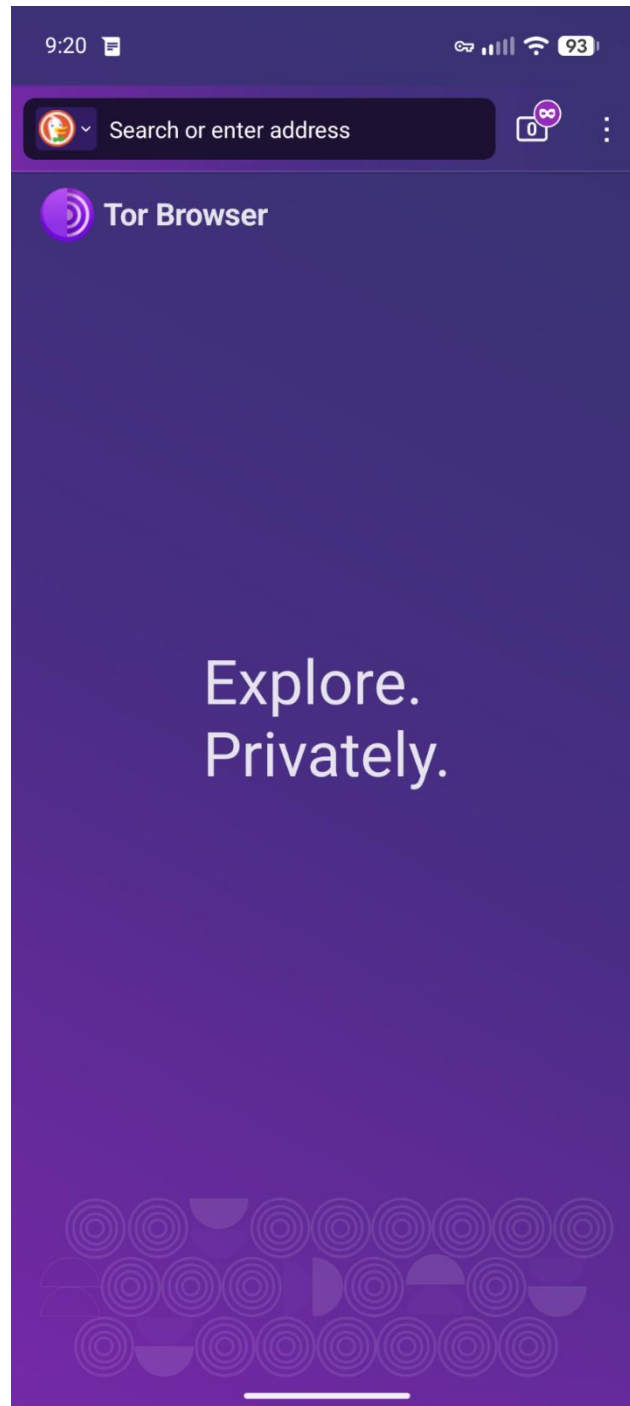
REMOTE VIEWING LINK

SHUTDOWN SYSTEM

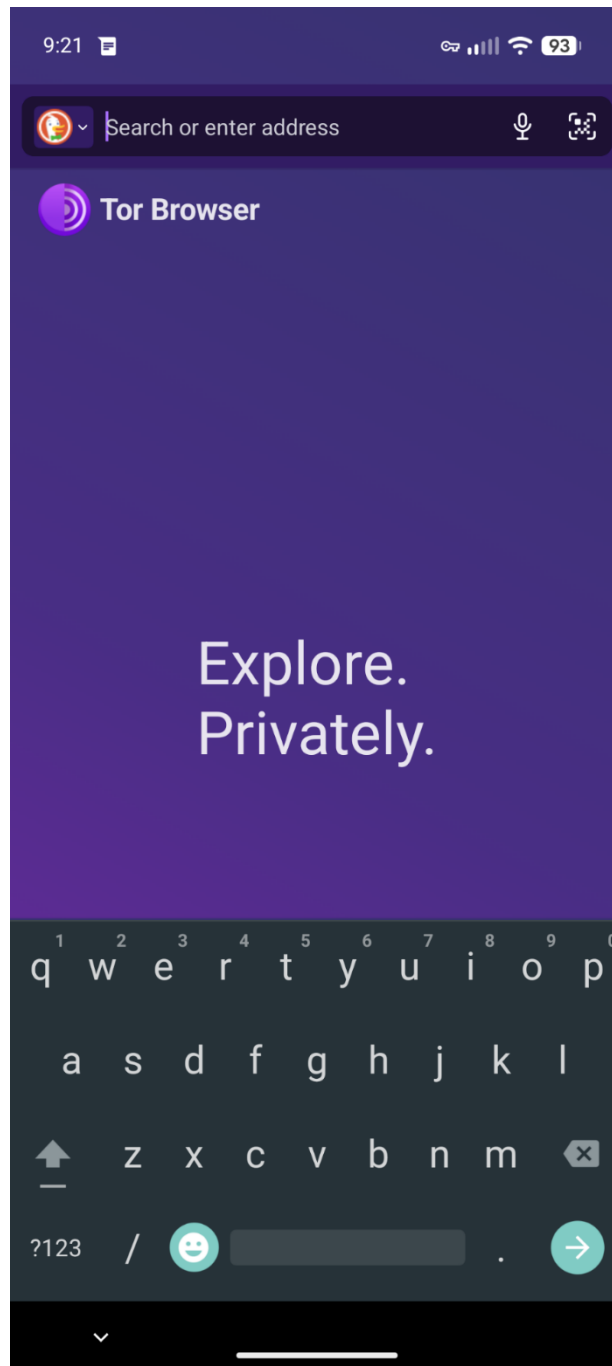
Part 6: Access HotWalletOS from a mobile device

Use Tor Browser on your mobile device to interact with a running HotWalletOS system, just as you would on the system itself.

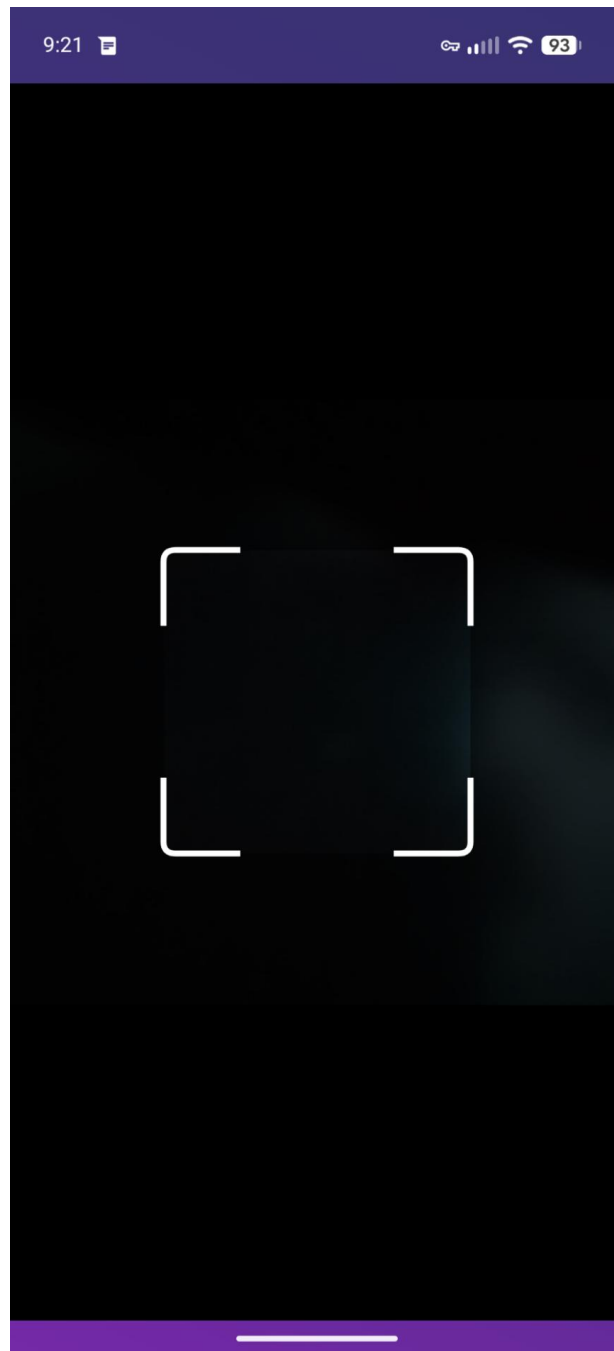
1. Open Tor Browser on your mobile device and connect.



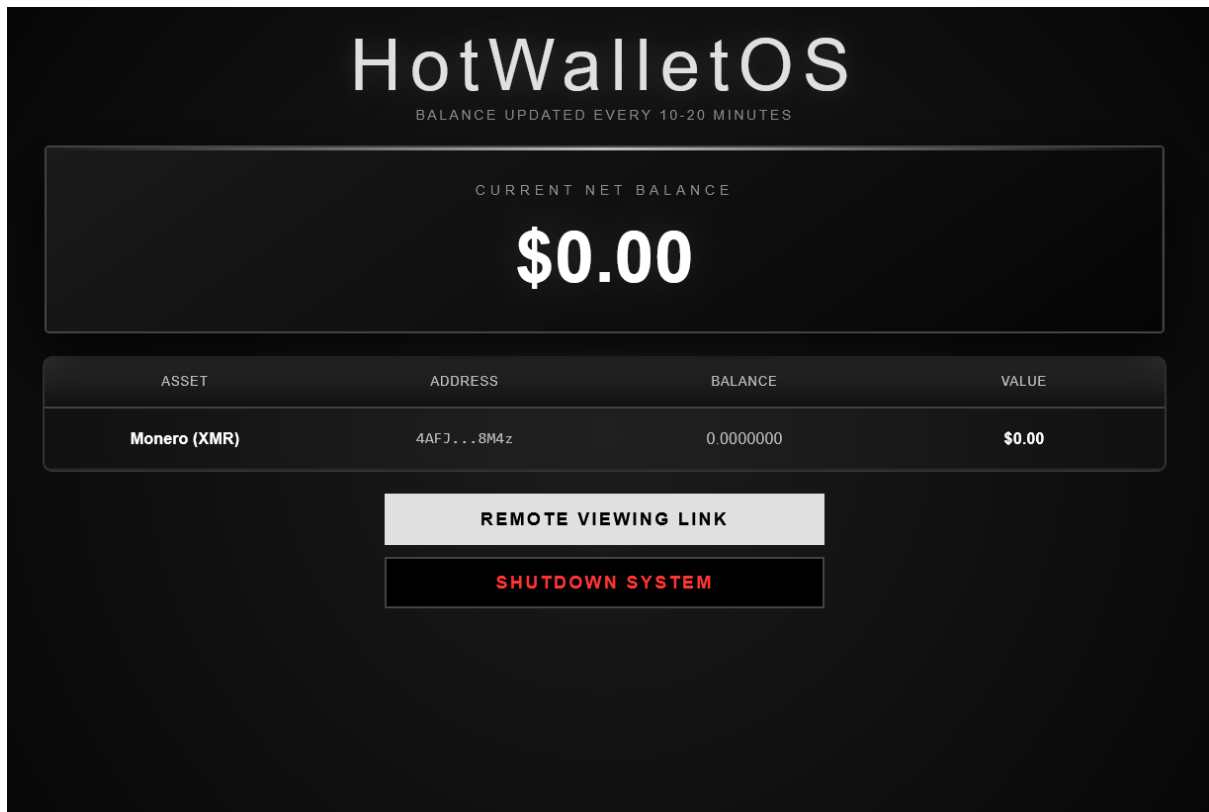
2. Select the address bar, then select the QR code icon on the far right.



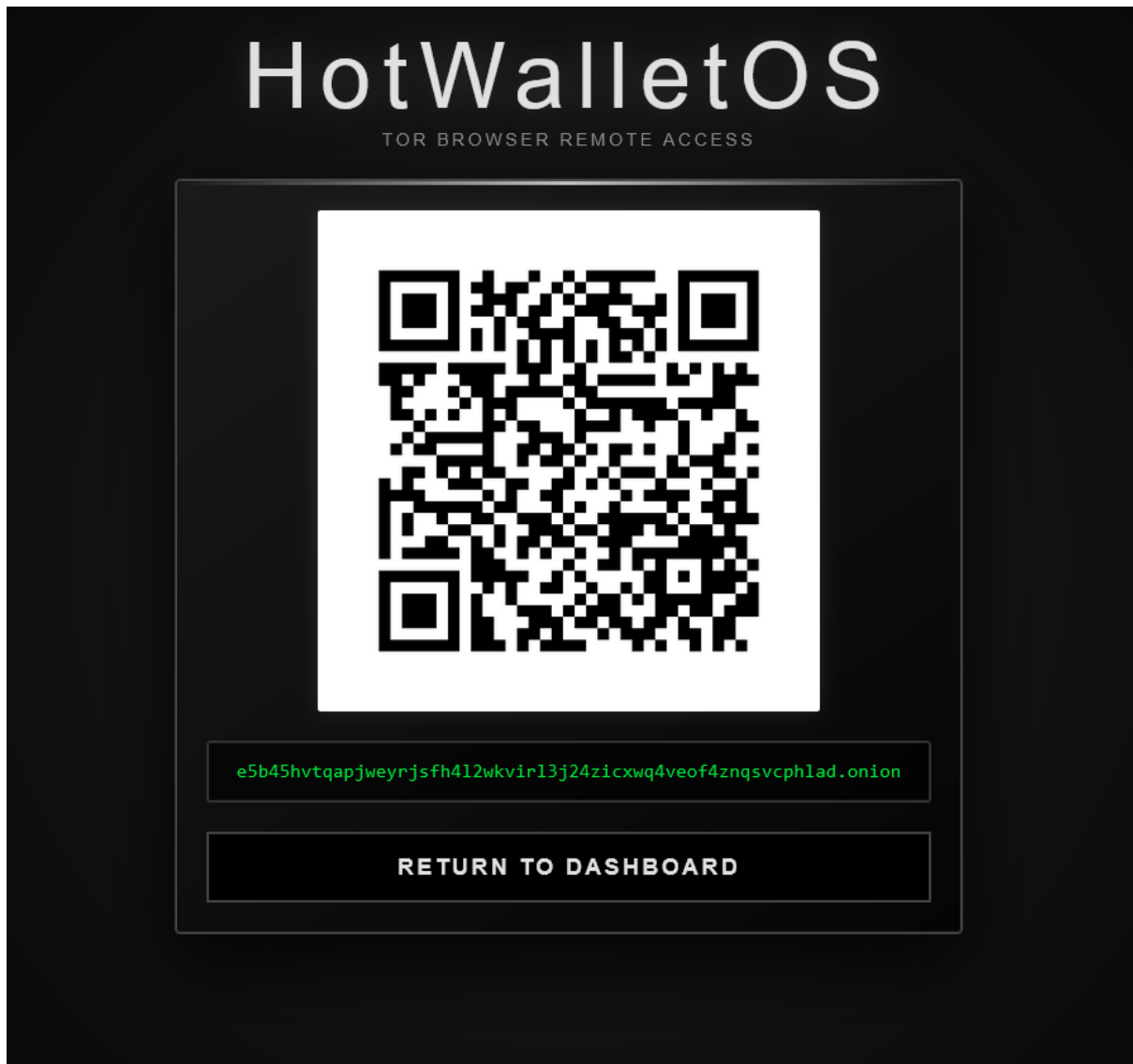
3. The QR code scanner opens.



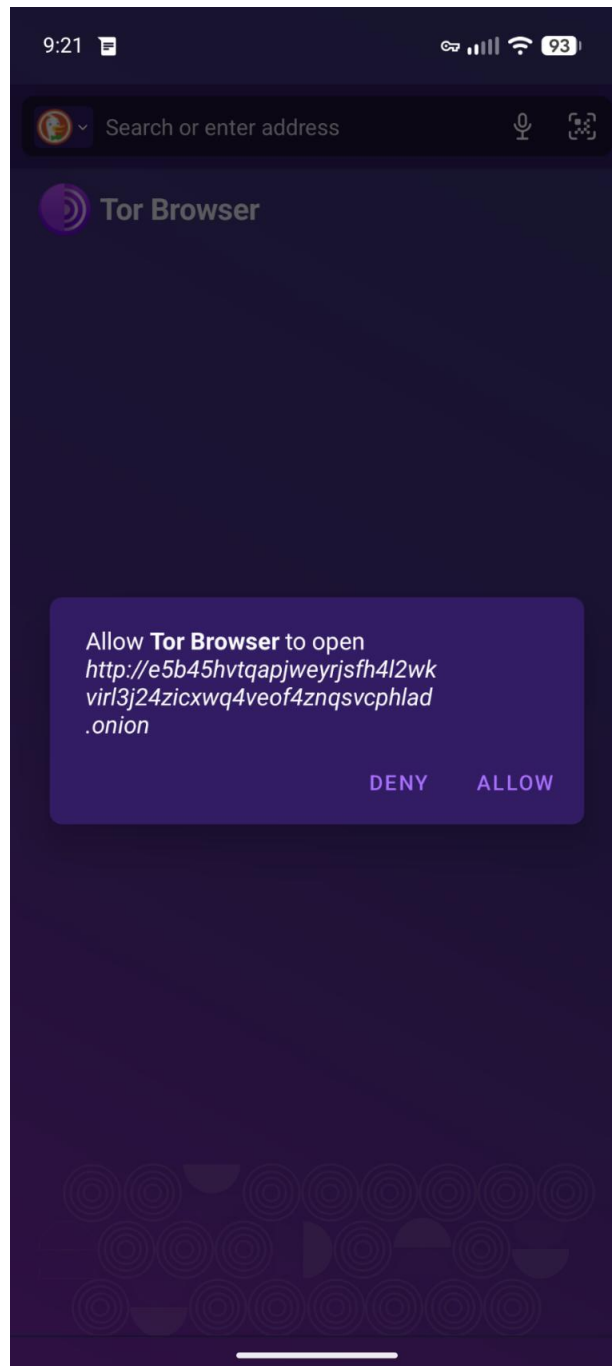
4. On the running system, select **Remote Viewing Link**, just as you did earlier.



5. Scan the QR code with your mobile device.



6. Confirm that you want the app to open the link.



7. You can now use Tor Browser to interact with HotWalletOS, just as you would on the system itself.

